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Ship targeted as U.S. intensifies strikes
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NEARBY



Will not tolerate corruption: CM

CHENNAI Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay warned his Cabinet colleagues and senior officials that he would not tolerate corruption in their departments. Sources said the CM made it clear that he would not hesitate to take action against anyone found guilty. » PAGE 8

Experts to assess safety of dams

CHENNAI Mettur, Bhavanisagar, Amaravathy and Vaigai are among 86 dams and reservoirs in the State which will come under the scrutiny of panels of experts in the next six months. » PAGE 8

FRIDAY REVIEW » 4 PAGES

Wangchuk weak, Delhi HC orders regular monitoring

Wangchuk has lost over 9 kg after starting hunger strike and his body is consuming muscles and his organs may be next, says doctor; govt. assures High Court of necessary medical intervention

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

With activist Sonam Wangchuk’s health condition worsening on the 19th day of his indefinite hunger strike at Jantar Mantar, the Delhi High Court ordered the Union and Delhi governments to ensure regular monitoring of his health.

Doctors warned on Thursday that Mr. Wangchuk’s health condition had entered a critical stage. Satish Lamba, a doctor who has been examining Mr. Wangchuk regularly, said he has lost over 9 kg, but is “mentally alert”. However, Dr. Lamba warned later in the evening that his body was likely consuming muscles and his organs may be next.



Holding ground: Sonam Wangchuk during his hunger strike at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Thursday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Mr. Wangchuk’s “blood sugar today is 80 mg/dl, and his pulse is 72 bpm,” Dr. Lamba said. He said that doctors were maintaining “extra vigilance” and that at his current stage, Mr. Wangchuk’s uric acid levels were likely elevated as his muscles were likely being broken down

by his body. He now weighs 56.9 kg. Earlier in the day, the Delhi High Court ordered that Mr. Wangchuk must be “regularly medically checked up by government doctors.” A Bench of Chief Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia asked Solicitor-

General Tushar Mehta whether any mechanism was in place to monitor Mr. Wangchuk’s health. Mr. Mehta submitted that Mr. Wangchuk undergoes a daily health check-up. “He [Mr. Mehta] further assures the court that depending upon the opinion of the doctors, whatever medical intervention is needed to check the deteriorating health condition of Mr. Wangchuk will also be taken,” the court recorded in its order.

The Bench passed the direction while hearing a public interest litigation (PIL) petition filed by advocate and activist Rakesh Kumar Saini.

CONTINUED ON
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MORE VOICES OF SUPPORT
» PAGE 13

Kudankulam ‘data breach’ unrelated to nuclear activity: govt.

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Union Minister of State for Atomic Energy Jitendra Singh on Thursday downplayed concerns regarding the data breach involving electronic files linked to the Kudankulam nuclear power plant in Tamil Nadu. “This [the breach] has nothing to do with the nuclear plant or nuclear security,” he told *The Hindu*. “There’s no need for any immediate review because what has happened is not linked to nuclear activity.”

A senior official of Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd. (NPCIL) – the plant operator – told *The Hindu* that the organisation was not, at present, contemplating a formal police investigation. “Right now, we aren’t contemplating an FIR because it is Reliance’s data that has been breached – in fact, Reliance could take such ac-



This (the breach) has nothing to do with the nuclear plant or nuclear security... there is no need for any immediate review because what has happened is not linked to nuclear activity

JITENDRA SINGH
Union Minister of State for Atomic Energy



tion if they wished to. From our perspective, no data regarding safety has been shared [with Reliance Infrastructure Limited]. Such kind of information on BoP (Balance of Plant) is shared with many companies,” Prateek Agrawal, Executive Director (CP &CC), NPCIL, said.

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Frame policy for release of terminally ill inmates: SC

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday directed all States and Union Territories to put in place, within three months, a uniform policy governing the premature release of elderly and terminally ill prisoners, observing that such inmates are entitled to a humane and time-bound mechanism for remission or early release on compassionate grounds.

A Bench comprising Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta directed that every State policy must clearly lay down the eligibility criteria and procedural framework governing such releases.

The directions were issued while hearing a petition filed by the National Legal Services Authority.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 14

Fervent surge



The chariots of Shree Jagannath Temple deities stand in front of the temple before their journey during the annual Rath Yatra in Puri. Two persons were killed and several injured in a crowd surge during the pulling of chariots on Thursday. BISWARANJAN ROUT (REPORT ON PAGE 14)

11.21 lakh clear NEET re-test as women outperform men

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A total of 11.21 lakh candidates qualified in the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET-UG) 2026 re-examination held on June 21, as the National Testing Agency declared the results on Thursday. Nearly 20 lakh candidates had appeared for the re-examination following the cancellation of the original exam, held on May 3, due to an alleged paper leak. These successful candidates are now eligible for admissions into undergraduate medical (MBBS), dental (BDS), AYUSH, and allied courses nationwide. Two candidates, Aryan Gupta from Punjab and



Test hurdle: Nearly 20 lakh students appeared for the re-test following cancellation of the original exam due to a paper leak. PTI

Panshul Bansal from Haryana, secured the highest score of 715 (out of 720 marks). Women aspirants registered a stellar performance, accounting for over 58% of the candidates in the qualified pool. They also outshone men in the overall qualification rate – 56.8% of the women

cleared the exam compared with 55.1% of men. Of the top 138 candidates (scores above 690), 93% cracked the exam on their first attempt, with 99% of them aged between 17 and 19 years.

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CB-CID begins probe into registration of math land

B.Tilak Chandar
DINDIGUL

The Crime Branch-Criminal Investigation Department (CB-CID) on Thursday began an investigation into the fraudulent registration of 1.35 acres of land belonging to the Arulmigu Dhandapani Swamigal Madam (math) at the foothills of Palani in Dindigul district.

A team of 15 police officers, led by Deputy Superintendent of Police (DSP) Ajay Thangam, conducted inquiries in Palani.

The Palani Adivaram police had registered a case against Sub-Registrar Justin Manikandan Subramanian, who was later suspended, and others.

The State government subsequently transferred the probe into the case to the CB-CID.

Handover of files

The police handed over all the case-related documents to the CB-CID team, comprising Inspector Santhanalakshmi, the DSP, and other officials. The team arrived at the Palani Devasthanam head office and conducted inquiries. It examined documents pertaining to the land issue, including the objections raised by the math with the Registration Department, and recorded the statements of the temple officials and staff members.

Meanwhile, the Registration Department has formed a three-member committee to conduct a thorough inquiry into the fraudulent registration of the temple land.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8



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Delhi - Amritsar - Katra Expressway (Cost: approx. ₹9,700 crore)

- Delhi to Katra journey made easier - now takes just 6 hours instead of 14 hours
- Haryana's Jhajjar, Sonipat, Jind and Kaithal districts connected to the expressway

Ambala - Kala Amb National Highway (Cost: approx. ₹1,200 crore)

- Stronger connectivity between Haryana and Himachal Pradesh
- Reduced transport time and logistics costs for industries
- Safer travel for the public, new momentum for trade

Pandit Neki Ram Sharma Government Medical College

(Cost: approx. ₹600 crore)

- Bhiwani district hospital upgraded into a medical college
- 630-bedded hospital
- Classes begun following admission to 100 MBBS seats

Jind - Gohana National Highway (Cost: approx. ₹1,600 crore)

- Jind-to-Gohana travel time reduced from 2 hours to just 40 minutes
- To help farmers reach agricultural produce markets more easily
- Better connectivity to Rohtak-Panipat-Delhi NCR

Kurukshetra Elevated Railway Track (Cost: approx. ₹400 crore)

- Smoother traffic flow
- Five railway level crossings in highly populated areas removed
- Relief to public from traffic congestion

Maharishi Chyawan Medical College (Cost: approx. ₹900 crore)

- Treatment capacity increased with a 650-bedded hospital
- Admissions to 100 MBBS seats
- OPD facility started

Sikh Museum, Kurukshetra (Cost: approx. ₹160 crore)

- Inspiring younger generation with the heritage, life, and cultural significance of the Sikh Gurus

Hansi - Barwala National Highway (Cost: approx. ₹140 crore)

- Better road connectivity between Hisar and Panchkula
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INBRIEF



Tourism Minister inaugurates three-day travel mart expo

The India International Travel Mart Chennai 2026 was inaugurated by Minister for Tourism S. Rajesh Kumar in the city on Thursday. After inaugurating the exhibition, he also launched the pavilion of the Tamil Nadu Tourism Development Corporation (TTDC). Rohit Hangal, director of Sphere Travelmedia and Exhibitions, which has organised the event, said that this year, more than 400 exhibitors from various parts of the country and also from Bhutan and Nepal, have showcased nearly 28 national and international destinations. The exhibition would be on till July 18.

TEXPO 2026 brings together 299 industrial exhibitors

The Thirumudivakkam Industrial Estate Manufacturers Association hosted TEXPO 2026, one of Tamil Nadu's significant business-to-business industrial exhibitions, at the SIDCO Industrial Estate in Thirumudivakkam near Chennai. The exhibition featured around 299 exhibitors. "We have received around 2,000 registrations, and all the participants are from various industries," said R. Selvam, chairman of TEXPO 2026. Kancheepuram Collector D. Sneha thanked the participants for contributing to the region's economic development. "Such expos will help MSMEs forge more collaborations," she said. R.V. Chari, chairman of Confederation of Indian Industries Chennai Zone, said automation, artificial intelligence, and new product development were the way forward. S. Vasudevan, Tamil Nadu Small and Tiny Industries Association president, said more public sector companies should be invited to participate in such events.

2 persons held for beating man to death in Padappai

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Somangalam police have arrested two persons for allegedly beating to death a 32-year-old man in Padappai.

The deceased, identified as Rajesh, was a resident of Sethupattu, near Somangalam, in Kancheepuram district. The police said Rajesh accompanied Than-gam and Anandajothi to consume alcohol on Wednesday night and never returned home.

On Thursday, Thangam and Anandajothi appeared before the Somangalam police and allegedly confessed that they had beaten Rajesh while they were intoxicated and he died. The police immediately detained the duo and questioned them.

During the interrogation, they claimed Rajesh had made obscene remarks about their families, and had beaten him in a fit of rage. The police took the accused to the scene of the crime and recovered Rajesh's body, which was found with severe facial injuries. The police have registered a murder case and arrested the duo

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Time: 6.00 PM (Book Launch) | 6.30 PM (Concert)

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OMCs yet to issue new LPG connections to domestic consumers

Distributors say this is despite normalisation of supply. Many consumers say they have been waiting since March, when conflict in West Asia began

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Despite normalisation of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) supplies to both domestic and commercial customers, distributors said the oil marketing companies (OMCs) were yet to issue new domestic connections.

People, who have been waiting since March, when the conflict began in West Asia, said they were vexed.

"We got married in February, and I brought my wife Radha to Chennai in March. We have been managing with an induction stove given to us by our houseowner. It is slow and not all utensils can be used with an induction stove. Rarely, we use the houseowner's gas stove. The gas agency suggested that we buy the small cylinder, but that is too costly for us," said Uthanraj, who works at a provision store in the city.

Another newly-wed couple, who got married in May, said they had submitted their application for a new LPG connection but had become fed up of asking the agency when they will get the connection.

Another consumer in south Chennai said that for



High demand: Distributors say they have been receiving customers asking for new LPG connections almost every single day. R. RAGU

the past few years, they had been managing on cylinders supplied by gas delivery boys. When she tried to get a connection, she was told to get a 5-kg connection. "Not all agencies are providing such connections. It took some push to get it done. I hope when the situation is normalised, I will be able to convert it to a domestic double-bottle connection," she said.

Distributors said their agencies were receiving walk-in customers asking for new connections almost every single day. "We are unable to provide new connections. We have only been noting their names and phone numbers with the promise of issuing cylinders as soon as possi-

ble," said a distributor.

Sale of stoves and hoses

Another distributor said OMC officials had been pressuring them to sell stoves and hoses despite the fact that no new connections were being issued.

"If new connections are issued, we can sell gas stoves. But now, consumers cannot simply be told to buy stoves for no reasons. With the orange hose, it is another story altogether. Some distributors are saddled with thousands of hoses. It will take them at least two years to sell 4,000 hoses. So, we would be giving consumers hoses that have a short lifespan," he added.



Health Minister K.G. Arunraj and Navin Gnanasekaran, longevty physician and head of radiology at Apollo Hospitals, Chennai, releasing the latter's book in Chennai on Thursday. R. RAGU

'District hospitals to have master health check-up service'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government plans to expand its master health check-up service to government hospitals in districts such as Madurai and Coimbatore, Health Minister K.G. Arunraj said on Thursday.

Speaking at the launch of the book *The 100-Year Blueprint*, authored by Navin Gnanasekaran, longevty physician and head of radiology at Apollo Hospitals, Chennai, Mr. Arunraj said the master health check-up service at the Kalaignar Centenary Super Speciality Hospital in Chennai had been witnessing high demand and appointments were being booked well in advance.

The State government will consider extending the facility to major government hospitals in other districts, he said, adding that

the government's primary focus would be to promote health rather than merely treating diseases.

Congratulating Dr. Gnanasekaran on his first book, Dr. Arunraj said it was the "need of the hour".

The *100-Year Blueprint*, published by Pan Macmillan India, presents an India-specific approach to healthy ageing by combining evidence-based guidance on nutrition, physical activity, sleep, stress management, and preventive health screening.

Dr. Gnanasekaran highlighted the growing burden of non-communicable diseases in India, citing the Indian Council of Medical Research's 2024 estimates that one in four Indians is diabetic or prediabetic. In Tamil Nadu, he said, the prevalence of diabetes was nearly twice than that of the national average.

Periyar Nagar post office gets Passport Seva Kendra

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Union Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting and Parliamentary Affairs L. Murugan launched the Post Office Passport Seva Kendra (POPSK) in Periyar Nagar on Thursday.

This is the second such facility in the city after Chennai GPO. Pointing out that the new POPSK would benefit north Chennai residents, Mr. Murugan said the post offices had been integrated to provide public utility services, including banking, insurance, and Aadhar services, under a single roof.

The Union government is working to ensure that government services reach people at the grassroots level. The benefits of various central social welfare schemes are being transferred directly into the bank accounts of beneficiaries through the Direct Benefit Transfer mechanism since 2014.

Mr. Murugan handed over the first passport processed at the new centre to the parents of a six-month-old infant. This is part of the goal of the Union Ministry of External Affairs to open one POPSK in every Parliamentary constituency. Designed to handle high density of applicants from north Chennai and its fringes, the POPSK will initially cater to about 40 applicants daily before gradually scaling up to 90.

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I, ZAINA (Given name) and (Surname), Daughter of Syed Ziauddin Abid, Resident of No. 4, Shanmugam Street, Madhi Azhagan Nagar, Saigaram, Chennai, Pin: 600093, Tamil Nadu, India and holding Passport No. X5891645 issued at Riyadh on 14/03/2023 hereby announce to change my name as Zaina (Given name) and Syed Ziauddin Abid (Surname) for all future purposes.

I, SYED Ziauddin Abid, F/o. Daania (Given name) and (Surname), Resident of No. 4, Shanmugam Street, Madhi Azhagan Nagar, Saigaram, Chennai - 600093, Tamil Nadu, India, holding Passport No. X5890789 issued at Riyadh on 14/03/2023, hereby announce to change my minor daughter's name as Dania (Given name) and Syed Ziauddin Abid (Surname) for all future purposes.

I, GEETHA Lakshmi Vaidya, d/o Mahabaleshwara Vaidya born on 9th March 1983, residing at Ruby, Olympia Opaline Sequel Apts, Navalur, Chennai, have changed my name to Geethalakshmi Uppunda Vaidya vide affidavit dated 1st July 2026 at Chennai.

I, JAYALAKSHMI, W/o Ravi, DOB:16/01/1972, residing at No. 98, Kumargarai St, Padunelli, Kanchipuram-631502, shall henceforth be known as Lakshmi Ravi

I, Ganesh Annadurai, S/o Annadurai, residing at 493, South Street, Kididhanki Cherry, Silthambur, Thiruvavur, Tamil Nadu – 614102, have changed the spelling of my name from Ganesh Annadurai to Ganesh Annadurai. Henceforth, I shall be known as Ganesh Annadurai for all purposes.

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INBRIEF



P.S. Senior Secondary School wins Model UN competition

P.S. Senior Secondary School, Mylapore, was adjudged the best school at the Chettinad Vidyashram Model United Nations 2026 contest held recently. The four-day event featured 12 executive boards and committees, a release said. Rajesh Bhowmick, First Secretary and Head of Chancery, Deputy High Commission of Bangladesh in Chennai, Subhasri Vijayakumar, head of information and library, Goethe Institute/Max Mueller Bhavan, and S. Amudha Lakshmi, principal, Chettinad Vidyashram, spoke at the event.

Rotary Club donates therapy chamber to govt. hospital

The Rotary Club of Madras has handed over a Hyperbaric Oxygen Therapy (HBOT) Chamber to the Omandurar Government Multi Super Speciality Hospital on Thursday. The HBOT was procured with the support of Timken Foundation of Canton. A release said, the equipment will help enhance treatment for patients suffering from conditions such as diabetic foot ulcers, chronic non-healing wounds, burns, radiation injuries, and carbon monoxide poisoning.

Text & Context and Health

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (July 17, Friday), the following articles are available:

■ Kudankulam plant data leak: What happened and what we know newsth.live/kudankulamleak

■ Beyond weight loss: how GLP-1s can affect your skin, hair and nails newsth.live/glpseffect

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Kanchi Kamakoti CHILDS Trust Hospital launches clinic for cystic fibrosis

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Kanchi Kamakoti CHILDS Trust Hospital (KKCTH) in Chennai has launched a dedicated multi-disciplinary clinic for cystic fibrosis to bring diagnosis, treatment, and long-term management for children under one roof.

Explaining the challenges associated with cystic fibrosis, a genetic disorder that causes thick mucus to build up in the body, Janani Sankar, medical director, KKCTH, said at a press meet on Thursday that children presented with different symptoms, which often led to difficulties in early diagnosis. Having to go to multiple specialists at different centres also took an emotional and financial toll on families, she said.



The multi-disciplinary clinic for cystic fibrosis being launched at Kanchi Kamakoti CHILDS Trust Hospital on Thursday. M. SRINATH

Bala Ramachandran, head of paediatric intensive care, said cystic fibrosis was estimated to be present in 1 in 10,000 live births in India and many more children were likely living with it undiagnosed. He said the condition not only affected the lungs, but also caused nutritional deficiencies, diabetes, and other complications.

V.V. Vivekananad, consultant pulmonologist, said that the hospital was now offering advanced paediatric interventional pulmonology services, which would help children avoid invasive surgeries and quicken their recovery times. The clinic will function on the second Saturday of every month.

Panel for children in conflict with law yet to hold a meet

Meghna M.
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu Empowered Committee on Special Services for Children, meant to administer all the government homes functioning for children in conflict with law, has not convened a single meeting since its conception in 2024.

According to sources in the Children Welfare and Special Service department (CWSS), a meeting scheduled after the panel's formation was cancelled. Since then a meeting has not been called. The func-

tioning of the committee assumes importance as 12 inmates escaped from a Government Place of Safety in Athur, near Chengalpattu, recently. Child rights activists note that the committee could have worked to improve the mechanism and infrastructure for children in conflict with law. The committee was formed to implement the recommendations made by the one-man committee headed by retired Justice K. Chandru for the effective functioning and administration of government observation homes, spe-

cial homes, and places of safety. The 15-member committee, headed by the Chief Secretary, has the secretary of the Social Welfare Department as the member secretary, and the director of Children Welfare and Special Services as the convenor. Additionally, secretaries of eight other departments, including revenue, health, public works, school education, home, youth welfare, finance, and differently abled, are a part of the committee. The other members include the member secre-

School bus catches fire in Velachery; no staff, students on board

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A private school bus was gutted in a fire near Kaivelai in Velachery on Thursday evening, causing traffic disruption on Velachery-Tambaram road. No one was injured as the bus was not carrying any students or staff at the time of the incident.

According to the police, the driver, Ravi of Pallikaranai, had dropped off students after completing the day's trip and was driving the bus back to Pallikaranai.

As he noticed a smoke billowing from the engine, he immediately pulled over and inspected it, but the flames spread rapidly and engulfed the bus.

Firemen rushed to the spot and extinguished the blaze. However, the bus was completely gutted,



A screengrab of the video of the incident. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

leading to temporary disruption of traffic on the busy stretch.

Normal traffic resumed only after the gutted vehicle was removed from the road.

Preliminary inquiries indicated that the fire may have originated in the engine compartment, though the exact cause is yet to be determined.

The police are investigating the incident.

Agriculture officers urge govt. to roll back scheme

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A cross-section of agricultural officers has urged Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to roll back *Uzhavar Aluvalar Thodarbu Thittam-2.0* (UATT 2.0), which aims at unifying all wings of the Agriculture Department at the field level.

The officers say the scheme would be detrimental to the interests of farmers, as agricultural officers who focus on staple crops could not give advice on horticulture crops.

P. Sivakumar, president, Tamil Nadu Horticulture Officers' Welfare Association, said that only six of 86 subjects were shared by the horticulture and agriculture streams. "It is like asking physicians, instead of veterinarians, to treat animals, saying they are both doctors. If one pesticide works on a pest that occurs in paddy, using the same pesticide on roses for the same pest may lead to burning up the entire rose garden," he said.

S. Sivakumar, secretary, Tamil Nadu Horticulture Officers' Welfare Association, said that during a restructuring exercise of the department in 2007, several posts were handed over to the Horticulture wing. The aim of the UATT 2.0 is to get back those posts to the agricultural wing. It is better to create more posts if needed, he added.

G. Murugan, president, Tamil Nadu Assistant Horticulture Officers' Association, said if Mr. Vijay wanted to develop the State into a \$1.5 trillion economy, he must realise that horticulture will play a major role in achieving it.

Southern Railway announces safety drive for loco pilots

R. Srikanth
CHENNAI

The Chennai Division of Southern Railway has announced a 15-day safety drive to be strictly followed by loco pilots (LPs) and assistant loco pilots (ALPs) to avert Signal Passed At Danger (SPAD) incidents, which occurs when a train moves past a red signal without proper authorisation.

This safety drive comes in the wake of the suspension of the loco pilots and assistant loco pilots of the Yelagiri Express for signal jumping on July 6.

The Yelagiri Express, which departed from Dr. MGR Central Railway Station, halted at Avadi after loco pilot P.S. Rao complained of health issues. However, an inquiry revealed that he had jumped a red signal near Vyasarpadi Railway Station, and had resorted to health issues to avoid penal action. The suspension is based on a preliminary inquiry, even as the main inquiry is yet to be concluded.

Based on this incident and a few previous ones, the Chennai Division announced that a safety drive would be held till July 24 for all loco and assistant loco drivers.

A senior loco pilot said all the loco pilots were being punished for the mistakes of a few crew members. He said that though they welcomed the safety procedures, the loco pilots were under severe work pressure due to a large number of vacancies, which remained unfilled

for several years. The work pressure involves running the mail and express trains on time, as the loco staff would otherwise be penalised in the name of punctuality.

Another loco pilot said facilities such as running rooms had been modernised and that they did not have any grievances on that front. However, inadequate rest and poor sanctioning of leaves were detrimental to the morale of the LPs and ALPs. Though they were provided with more leave reserves and rest compared to other railway staff, the provisions were only on paper and not in actual practice, sources said.

Vacant posts

The Centre of Indian Trade Unions had said in a memorandum that around three lakh posts were lying vacant in the Railways, which had increased the workload for existing employees. Instead of filling up the posts, Railways had decided to surrender various posts in different departments.

In the Loco Running Category itself, around one third of the posts, which is around 39,000, are vacant. As a result, the existing loco running staff are forced to work 14 hours a day at a stretch.

Additionally, there are a significant number of vacancies in the Chief Loco Inspector (CLI) posts. CLIs are under pressure to force the loco running staff to work long hours, and are subjected to punitive measures if they fail to do so.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY



Prof. Dr. V. Padmavathi, Age 97
Hd SLET, Author & Painter
Passed Away on 14/7/26
Lovingly Remembered by
Daughter Lakshmi Murali
Son in Law Murali Bhaskar
Grand children Dr.Nirupama & Sreedhar
Priyanka & Shashank &
Great Grand children

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIRST YEAR ANNIVERSARY



E.R.S. JAGANATHAN
DOB: 15.03.1921 - DOD: 17.07.2025
B.A(Maths) National College B.E(Civil)
Guindy Engineering College
Retired Superintending Engineer (PWD)-
Township Administrator NLC and
Engineering Technical Member PAP,
Estate Officer of Tamilnadu Agricultural
University including Veterinary College
and Fisheries College and University
Engineer of Madurai Kamaraj University.
Fondly Remembered by:
Vijayakumar & Nandhani
Deepak & Rubini, Sharan & Monisha
Mirthi, Prajan & Pavi

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Date: 16.07.2026

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Ref: Approval of the Hon'ble Vice-Chancellor dated: 16.07.2026

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- The application fee of **Rs.300/- (Rs.150/- for SC/ST Category-I of Karnataka Domicile and transgender candidates only)** is payable through **online** only in **UUCMS portal/ Bangalore University website.**
- The last date for applying to **B.P.Ed. & PG courses of 2026-27** academic year **without penal fee 07.08.2026**. However candidates can apply till **11.08.2026** with a penal fee of **Rs.200/-**.
- The hard copies of the filled in **online application** / duly filled in **downloaded application** along with self attested photocopies of relevant documents shall be submitted separately to the respective PG departments with in **13.08.2026** for which the candidate seeks admission.
- For more details visit the Bangalore University website; <https://bangaloreuniversity.karnataka.gov.in>

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No: BECC/EE/HAL/TEND/02/2026-27	Date: 15.07.2026
INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT) (Two cover system) (Short Term Tender Notification) (Through GOK http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in only)	
The Executive Engineer, HAL Airport Division, BECC, invites tenders on behalf of the Commissioner, BECC, Bengaluru from eligible Tenderers for the construction works detailed in the table below. The tenderers may submit tenders for works given in the table through KPP Portal of the Government of Karnataka (viz https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in). The Tenderers are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 3 of the Instructions to Tenderers to qualify for award of the contract. Other details can be seen in the tender documents.	
Sl. No.	Name of the Work/Estimated Cost (in lakhs)/EMD (in Rs)/Period of work Completion
1	Improvements to roads and drains at B Narayanapura Village @ Census Block Number.53 and Surrounding area ward No.21 A. Narayanapura. Estimated Cost : 99.98 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.1,99,960/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
2	Improvements to roads and drains at Shivashakti Colony and pushpanjali tent surrounding @ Census Block Number.92 & 93 and Surrounding area ward No.21 A.Narayanapura (ST Reserved). Estimated Cost : 99.99 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.99,990/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
3	Improvements to roads and drains Andra colony and A Narayanapura main road @ Census Block Number 111 and Surrounding area ward No.21 A Narayanapura. Estimated Cost : 99.97 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.1,99,940/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
4	Improvements to roads and drains at Vibhuthipura and shiva shakti colony @ Census Block Number 67/1 & 102/2 and Surrounding area ward No.27 Vibhuthipura ward. (CAT-I Reserved). Estimated Cost : 99.98 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.99,980/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
5	Improvements to roads and drains at kumbhar kote @ Census Block Number.91 & 164 and Surrounding area ward No.23 Sangam ward (CAT-II(A) Reserved). Estimated Cost : 99.97 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.99,970/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
6	Improvements to roads and drains at Islampura and new Annasandra palya @ Census Block Number.131 and Surrounding area ward No.25 L.B.Shashthri nagara ward. Estimated Cost : 99.99 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.1,99,980/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
7	Improvements to Roads and Drains at Nellurupura @ Census Block No.148 and Surrounding areas ward No. 26 Jagadeesh nagar. Estimated Cost : 99.98 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.1,99,960/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
8	Developments to Roads and Drains at Jagadeesh nagar @Census Block No. 173/1 and Surrounding areas Ward No.26 Jagadeesh nagar (SC Reserved). Estimated Cost : 99.99 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.99,990/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
9	Developments to Roads and Drains at Nellurupura @ Census Block No.148 and Surrounding areas ward No. 26 Jagadeesh nagar (CAT-II(A) Reserved). Estimated Cost : 99.96 Lakhs , EMD : Rs.99,960/- . Period For Completion : 6 Months .
Calendar of events: 1. Documents can be download in Kppp on 17-07-2026 . 2. Last date of submission queries : 20-07-2026 within 11.00. A.M. 3. Date & time for Pre Bid Meeting : 20-07-2026 at 11.30 A.M. 4. Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders: 24-07-2026 Upto 4:00 P.M. 5. Date & Time for Opening Technical bid: 27-07-2026 at 4.30 P.M. 6. Date & Time for Opening Financial bid: 28-07-2026 at 4.00 P.M. 7. Validity of Tenders : 180 Days .	
Sd/- Executive Engineer HAL Airport, Zone-2, BECC	

From Page One

CB-CID begins probe into registration of math land in Palani

The committee comprises the Additional Inspector-General of Registration, the Assistant Inspector-General of Registration, and the District Registrar.

It will conduct a detailed inquiry with the Sub-Registrar (in-charge), who was on duty on the day of the registration, the Sub-Registrar who was on leave, the District Registrar, and the assistants.

On Wednesday, the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court allowed the appeal filed by the math, and declared as null and void a controversial sale deed executed in favour of certain individuals with regard to the 1.35 acres of land.

INBRIEF



SC closes Tamil Nadu SIR case following Bihar SIR verdict

The Supreme Court on Thursday closed the proceedings on 13 petitions filed by political parties and leaders, challenging the conduct of a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Tamil Nadu. A Bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant took note of submissions by petitioners that the case did not require further adjudication in view of the court's judgment on the Bihar SIR, and disposed of all 13 petitions. On May 27, a Bench headed by the CJI delivered its judgment on a batch of petitions challenging SIR in Bihar, and upheld the Election Commission's power to conduct the exercise.

Nagenthran appears in court in cash seizure case

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu BJP president Nainar Nagenthran on Thursday appeared before a court in Chennai and received a copy of the charge-sheet filed in a case relating to the seizure of ₹3.99 crore on the Nellai Express ahead of the 2024 parliamentary election.

On April 6, 2024, a Flying Squad team seized ₹3.99 crore from three men aboard Nellai Express at Tambaram. It was alleged that the cash was meant for distribution to voters in Tirunelveli, at the instruction of Mr. Nagenthran, who was contesting the election as the BJP's candidate. The Flying Squad officials informed the Tambaram police, who registered a case and arrested the three men. One of the arrested persons, S. Sathish, was the manager of the Blue Diamond hotel in Purasawalkam, owned by Mr. Nagenthran, and a member of the BJP.

Based on a complaint, the three were booked and arrested. The recovered cash was handed over to the tahsildar after informing the Income Tax Department. A couple of weeks later, the case was transferred to the Crime Branch-CID, which filed the charge-sheet against 13 persons, including Mr. Nagenthran and the BJP's former organising secretary, Kesava Vinayagam.

Will not tolerate corruption, CM warns Ministers, officials

Chairing a Cabinet meeting, Vijay makes it clear that he will not hesitate to take action. He also asks Ministers not to make a spectacle out of inspections related to their departments

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Thursday warned his Cabinet colleagues and senior officials that he would not tolerate corruption or irregularities in their departments.

Sources said the Chief Minister made it clear during a Cabinet meeting that he would not hesitate to take action against anyone found guilty, and that no one could fault him for doing so.

“Do not think that we will be in power for only five years, and that you can do whatever you want. We will continue to govern the State,” he is learnt to have said at the meeting.

Mr. Vijay also advised the Ministers not to make a spectacle out of inspections related to their departments.

“We are here to serve the people. Do not bring the government into disrepute. I will also take action against officials who are unwilling to cooperate with the government in implementing its programmes and achieving its goals,” he said.

Budget discussion

Details of the upcoming State Budget were also discussed during the Cabinet meeting.



Talking tough: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay chairing a Cabinet meeting at the Secretariat in Chennai on Thursday.

Speaking to reporters after the meeting, Law Minister R. Nirmalkumar said it was a routine meeting ahead of the presentation of the Budget. “In today's Cabinet meeting, deliberations were held on what should be included in the Budget, and how it should be presented. These matters cannot be disclosed publicly yet,” the Minister said.

Custodial death

To a query, he said strict action would be taken against those responsible for the death of remand prisoner S. Sabari Varman in Nagercoil.

“If a death occurs in prison, this government will definitely take stringent action. Previous governments used to cover up such incidents. However, based on the Chief Minister's orders, cases were registered two days ago, and everyone involved has been arrested,” he said. He added that in cases of prison or lock-up deaths, the government would stand by the victims.

DMK-AIADMK-BJP ‘pact’

Claiming that the DMK, the AIADMK, and the BJP were trying to form a government together, he sarcastically said, “Unable to run their own parties, the DMK and the AIADMK might merge with the BJP in two or three years, securing, perhaps, two Cabinet Minister posts each for (DMK president) Mr. Stalin's family and (AIADMK general secretary) Mr. Palaniswami's family.”

The Minister claimed that attempts were being made to “buy” TVK MLAs, with offers ranging from

₹30 crore to ₹50 crore.

Alleging corruption in the Registration Department over the past five years, the Minister levelled serious charges against former Registration Minister P. Moorthy. “A person was stationed at every registration office to collect the ‘Minister's cutting’ (commission). If you were to register a property worth ₹1 lakh, ₹20,000 would be spent on bribes,” the Minister claimed.

He emphasised that if anyone demands a bribe, action will be taken immediately if a complaint is lodged via the toll-free number.

When asked about the cancellation of several projects initiated during the previous administration, he said, “Projects in every department were designed with a 20% to 30% commission built into them. By revising old tenders, we are cutting down the money meant for commission. We have instructed officials to eliminate the 30% commission that was taken previously, and resubmit the tenders.”

Regarding the appointment of government lawyers, he said that 80% to 90% of the appointments had already been made. If any unsuitable or inept individuals were found to have been appointed, they will be replaced, he added.

Census 2027: process of enumerating self from today

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The self-enumeration process, which is part of Phase 1 of Census 2027 in Tamil Nadu, is scheduled to commence on July 17 (Friday), M. Sundaresh Babu, Chief Principal Census Officer, Directorate of Census Operations, Tamil Nadu, said in Chennai on Thursday.

Addressing a press conference, Mr. Babu said the self-enumeration process was scheduled from July 17 to 31. The portal for the purpose will open on Friday, he said.

“The data shared with the enumerators would be stored safely,” he said.

When the Census enumerators visit them, those who have completed self-enumeration can share the details of the unique self-enumeration ID with them, he said.

The field activity, i.e., the house listing and housing Census, would be carried out between August 1 and 30, the official said.

The portal was available in 16 languages, he added.

For the first time, the Census would be carried out in a digital format, he said, adding that the enumerators had been provided with mobile applications, and the data collected by them would go to the data server directly.

Each enumerator would undertake the Census in 200-250 households, he said.

Police question TV journalist in TVK MLA bribery case

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Triplicane police in Chennai have questioned a senior editor of Puthiya Thalaimurai and seized his mobile phone for a cyber forensic analysis in connection with a claim by N. Elaiyaraja, the TVK MLA from Uthangarai, that he was offered ₹35 crore to vote against the ruling party in the House.

The police said the journalist was examined over two days. According to an official press release, investigators found that he had been in contact with the prime accused during the purported conspiracy.

In his complaint, the MLA alleged that Tirunavukkarasu, a YouTuber from Arumbakkam in Chennai, who runs a polling agency named IPDS, along with several others,

had attempted to influence him to vote against the stand taken by the TVK in the Assembly.

He alleged that they had offered him a bribe of ₹35 crore to vote as instructed by them and, when he refused to do so, made death threats against him and his family.

The police said Tirunavukkarasu, along with others, had entered into a criminal conspiracy under the name “Meghalaya Project” to buy the support of around 15 TVK MLAs by offering them large sums of money, with the intention of destabilising the government.

‘In continuous contact’

“During the examination of documentary evidence in the case, the police found that Mr. Vijayan, Senior News Editor of Puthiya Thalaimurai Television,

had sent objectionable messages to the arrested accused, Tirunavukkarasu, and had remained in continuous contact with him during the alleged conspiracy,” the release said.

As part of the investigation, a summons was issued to Mr. Vijayan, who appeared before the police and was questioned on July 15 and 16. His statement was recorded. His mobile phone was obtained for a cyber forensic analysis to examine evidence related to the case.

He had been instructed to continue cooperating with the ongoing investigation, the city police said in a statement.

The Chennai Press Club, in a statement, urged Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to intervene and ensure that the journalist is not harassed by the police on the pretext of an investigation.

86 dams and reservoirs across State to be monitored by independent panels of experts

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Mettur, Bhavanisagar, Amaravathy, and Vaigai are among the 86 dams and reservoirs in the State that will come under the scrutiny of independent panels of experts in the next six months.

The experts will examine 19 dams from the angles of safety, design, seismology, hydro mechanics, geology, hydrology, and instrumentation.

Former chairmen of the Central Water Commission (CWC) J. Chandrashekhara Iyer and A.K. Bajaj; former chiefs of the Krishna River Management Board Yoginder Kumar Sharma and Shailesh Kumar Srivastava; former Chief Engineer (CE) in the Tamil Nadu Water Resources Department R. Selvam; former CE in the



The experts will examine 19 dams for safety, design, seismology, hydro mechanics, geology, hydrology, and instrumentation.

CWC T.K. Sivarajan; former deputy director-general of the Geological Survey of India R. Srinivasan; and BIS [Bureau of Indian Standards] Chair Professor, National Institute of Technology, Tiruchi, K. Muthukumaran, are among the experts. The superintending engineer concerned will function as member-secretary of each panel.

Approving the formation of the panels, the Tamil Nadu government, in an order issued earlier this week, included Cholavaram, a balancing reservoir between the Satyamurti Sagar in Poondi and the Red Hills tank, all of which are meant for water supply to Chennai. The selection of the 85 dams and reservoirs has been done on the basis of the waterbodies

having been identified as specified dams under the National Dam Safety Act, 2021. These dams and reservoirs are under the jurisdiction of the Water Resources Department (WRD). In addition, 38 dams, being maintained by the Tamil Nadu Green Energy Corporation (TNGEC) in the State, have been added to the list, including Pykara and Kadamparai. The power utility has formed similar independent panels for dam safety evaluation.

Inter-State dams

The National Dam Safety Authority (NDSA) has put in place such a system for four inter-State dams – Mullaperiyar, Parambikulam, Thunakadavu, and Peruvuripallam – that come under its jurisdiction. In the run-up to the

enactment of the Act, Tamil Nadu had opposed the move to bring the dams under the NDSA's control, as it had argued that the dams “are owned, operated and maintained” by it, a claim contested by Kerala in view of the dams being located in its territory.

As per the law, the first comprehensive safety assessment for each dam should be carried out on or before December 30, 2026, when the deadline stipulated by the Act ends. The government has cleared the creation of the panels to facilitate the study.

Of the 123 dams in the State listed under the law, five dams are aged at least 100; 59 dams are aged between 50 and 99; 40 dams are between 25 and 49 years old; and 19 dams are less than 25 years old.

‘Execute Nadanthaai Vaazhi Cauvery project immediately’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Thursday urged the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) government to take up, at the earliest, the implementation of the Nadanthaai Vaazhi Cauvery project, which is aimed at rejuvenating Cauvery river and its tributaries, and curbing the mixing of sewage with the river system.

Criticising the government for indulging in “bragging” about itself and “horse trading”, besides publishing reels on social media, Mr. Palaniswami said the State government did not have to carry out any measure for people



and farmers in the Cauvery delta other than reviving the project. Recalling that he, as Chief Minister in 2019, had submitted to Prime Minister Narendra Modi a project proposal, which was estimated to cost ₹11,250 crore, the AIADMK leader said the Union government cleared the project in 2024, paving

the way for works to be executed at a cost of ₹935 crore. As per the approved funding pattern, the Union and State governments would share the cost in the ratio of 60:40. But the previous DMK regime took “no further step”, as a result of which the project did not take off, he said.

Mr. Palaniswami called upon Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay who, according to him, was living in “dreamworld”, to execute the project, which would take care of the drinking water and irrigation requirements of the people in the region.

He also reviewed the performance of the party in Cuddalore and Pudukottai districts.

Ensure Cauvery water for State: BJP to govt.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Expressing shock over the stand taken by Karnataka during a meeting of the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee, BJP leader Vanathi Srinivasan on Thursday urged Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to ensure that Tamil Nadu receives its due share of water from the neighbouring State.



Vanathi Srinivasan

‘Hollow excuses’

Referring to reports that Karnataka had refused to share Cauvery water, Ms. Srinivasan said it was an indication that the rights of Tamil Nadu were being undermined. She also accused Karnataka of giving “hollow excuses”.

“The TVK government, which is in an alliance with the Congress in Tamil Nadu, is being indifferent to the actions of the Congress government in Karnataka. The people of Tamil Nadu will not remain mute spectators to the actions of the TVK government,” Ms. Srinivasan said.

DMK urges Central govt. to form tribunal on Mekedatu

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK MPs on Thursday urged the BJP-led Union government to constitute a tribunal to resolve the dispute between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka over the proposed construction of a balancing reservoir at Mekedatu. The party also urged the Centre to prevail upon the Karnataka government to release Tamil Nadu's due share of Cauvery water.

A resolution to this effect was adopted at a virtual meeting of the MPs, attended by party president M.K. Stalin from London.

The resolution said Karnataka had failed to comp-



M.K. Stalin

ly with the final award of the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal by not releasing Tamil Nadu's due share of water. “The Mettur Dam could not be opened because of Karnataka's recalcitrant stand. This has caused enormous hardship to farmers,” a resolution adopted at the meeting said.

The resolution further stated that as long as the DMK was in power, it had prevented Karnataka from proceeding with the construction of the dam. “Our leader M.K. Stalin succeeded in persuading the Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change to reject Karnataka's proposal seeking permission for the construction of the dam, and ensured that the Cauvery Water Management Authority returned the detailed project report,” the resolution said.

Another resolution said the DMK MPs in both Houses of Parliament would raise their voice on issues concerning Tamil Nadu.

Oppose education Bill, Kerala Minister urges MPs from State

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Kerala Higher Education Minister Roji M. John has appealed to all MPs from the State to oppose the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBSA) Bill, 2025, arguing that several of its provisions would centralise control over higher education and weaken the constitutional role of States.

In a letter addressed to Kerala MPs in both Houses of Parliament, Mr. John said while the government was projecting the Bill as a reform measure aimed at improving higher education, research and innovation, he contended that its provisions had wider constitutional implications.

“Beneath the language of reform lies a framework that concentrates unprece-

dent ed powers in the Union government, weakens the constitutional role of the States, and threatens the autonomy of institutions”, the Minister said.

Mr. John argued that the Bill departed from the principle of cooperative federalism and pointed to Clause 49, which, he said, would allow the proposed law to override inconsistent State enactments.

The Minister also raised concerns over the governance structure envisaged under the Bill, especially the limited rotational representation for States in the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan, the apex body that would be replacing the University Grants Commission (UGC), the All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE), and the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE).

Establish digitised inventory for Sabarimala assets, says HC

Court tells Sabarimala Development Project officials to follow all procedural safeguards on public procurement, while considering the approval for a contract to supply cots for Sannidhanam staff

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court has directed the Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB) to establish a comprehensive, systematic, and preferably digitised inventory management system for all consumable and non-consumable assets maintained at the Sabarimala Sannidhanam and allied establishments.

It further directed the Chief Engineer and the Executive Engineer of the Sabarimala Development Project to ensure that every statutory requirement, financial rule, and procedural safeguard governing public procurement is scrupulously complied



The court was considering queries raised by the Audit department on a contract to supply 1,000 cots for Sannidhanam staff. FILE PHOTO

with, before finalising purchases.

A Division Bench of Justice Raja Vijayaraghavan V. and Justice K.V. Jayakumar passed the directives while considering the approval for a contract to supply 1,000 double-decker mild steel cots for daily wage

staff deployed at the Sannidhanam and the queries raised by the Audit department in this regard. The total estimate for the purchase was ₹1.66 crore, for which the TDB had granted administrative sanction.

One of the objections was that though the cots

SIT visits TDB office as part of 'gold theft' probe

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM
A special investigation team (SIT) inquiring into the alleged misappropriation of gold from the Sabarimala Ayyappa temple visited the Travancore Devaswom Board office on Thursday.

were to be supplied by a manufacturer in Tamil Nadu, neither its photographs nor technical specifications were placed before the Ombudsman. Moreover, the Ombudsman had noted that the tender process was initiated at the eleventh hour.

ISRO issues memo to curb exodus of staff from key missions

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

With about 100 Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) personnel quitting the space agency in various centres across the country, the Department of Space (DoS) has issued a memorandum to curb the exodus of scientists and engineers who are working in critical missions of national importance, like the Gaganyaan.

In a memorandum issued on July 14, signed by

S.R. Rajashekar, Joint Secretary (Personnel), Department of Space, it stated, “Of late, it is noticed that there has been spate of requests for voluntary retirement and resignation from Group ‘A’ Scientific/Technical personnel of the ISRO including those associated with the prestigious Gaganyaan and other important missions/projects severely impacting the implementation of projects of national importance.”

The memorandum addressed to Directors of the

ISRO Centers and Heads of Units has asked them to address this issue and not to accept any requests for voluntary retirement or resignation from scientific and technical personnel of Group ‘A’ associated with the Gaganyaan or other important missions or projects till their realisation.

“It has been decided that voluntary retirement and resignation requests from scientific and technical personnel associated with the Gaganyaan and other important mission/

projects may not be accepted as a matter of routine,” the memorandum stated.

It further noted that if requests for voluntary retirement and resignation are received from scientific, technical personnel, even below the rank of scientists/engineers-SG it may be sent to the DoS for final decision.

Union Minister of State Jitendra Singh downplayed suggestions of a manpower crisis. “I believe Mr. Narayanan [ISRO Chairman V.

Narayanan] has made a statement on that. As many go, that many will come - the project shouldn't suffer. The team is large; nobody is going away; they come and go. The memo was issued so that decisions can be taken at a much more mature level. The ISRO has a culture of working in continuity, with even retired personnel involved in projects... For instance the former chief S. Somanath worked closely on the Gaganyaan. Now he's not there. Does that

mean work on Gaganyaan stops?”

During the last Budget session of the Parliament, Mr. Singh on February 11, 2026, in a reply to a question on the details of the sanctioned, in-position and vacant positions in the ISRO, said that the overall sanctioned strength (Science and Technology and Administration) was 18,142. Of this there was a vacancy of 2,613 personnel.

(With inputs from Jacob Koshy in New Delhi)

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday

TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Friday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh and Vidarbha. Heat wave conditions likely at isolated places over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	25.4	32.5	25.6	Kurnool		37.8	27.8
Ahmedabad		37.0	27.5	Lucknow	18	33.6	26.2
Aizawl	27	32.5	23.8	Madurai		40.0	27.1
Bengaluru	0.2	23.8	20.7	Mangaluru	0.6	30.0	24.4
Bhopal		33.9	25.4	Mumbai	5	31.7	26.0
Bhubaneswar	1.8	26.8	24.8	Mysuru		33.0	18.4
Chandigarh		38.0	26.3	New Delhi		39.2	30.2
Chennai		39.9	28.2	Patna		37.0	29.0
Coimbatore		32.7	22.6	Port Blair	5.7	31.2	25.3
Dehradun	40.9	34.1	24.0	Prayagraj		37.0	28.4
Gangtok	10.4	23.5	19.1	Puducherry		38.4	27.8
Goa		32.4	27.2	Pune	0.4	31.1	23.3
Guwahati	1.4	35.4	26.5	Raipur		32.2	26.0
Hubballi		29.0	22.0	Ranchi	13	31.4	23.0
Hyderabad		35.1	25.6	Shillong		26.5	18.0
Imphal		32.1	23.8	Shimla		29	20.6
Jaipur		37.3	29.8	Srinagar		34.2	18.9
Kochi	0.8	30.2	25.6	Thiruvananthapuram		32.4	25.0
Kohima		25.0	20.0	Tiruchirappalli		39.1	27.0
Kolkata	5.2	32.3	26.4	Vijayawada		37.6	29.0
Kozhikode		34.3	26.0	Visakhapatnam		32.6	29.3

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	31	34	51	61	79	■	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Pandhgaon,
Bengaluru	9	34	51	65	117	■	Haryana recorded an
Chennai	5	6	32	65	228	■	overall air quality index
Delhi	10	47	41	152	356	■	(AQI) score of 267
Hyderabad	17	14	17	46	76	■	indicating an unhealthy
Kolkata	11	19	39	71	85	■	level of pollution. In
Lucknow	9	26	66	72	64	■	contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram
Mumbai	29	9	25	64	75	■	recorded a healthy AQI
Pune		22	81	26	57	■	score of 15
Visakhapatnam	25	17	14	82	149	■	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_x: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

TTD gets donations worth ₹96.98 crore in a single day

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUMALA

The Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams (TTD), which manages the operations of

the Lord Venkateswara Temple at Tirumala, received a staggering ₹96.98 crore in donations to its various trusts and schemes in a single day on Tuesday as

devotees rushed to beat the deadline for a sweep-in overhaul of donor privileges.

The unprecedented inflow came on the eve of the

implementation of TTD's revised donor privilege policy, which took effect on Wednesday. As many as 2,460 devotees made donations during the day.

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, K.R. Pura Division,
Old Madras road, K.R. Pura, Bengaluru-560036

No: BECC/EE/KRP/TEND/02/2026-27 Date: 16.07.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT)
(Short Term Tender Notification) Two Cover System
(Only through GoK KPP Portal)

The Executive Engineer, K. R. Pura Division, BECC, Bengaluru on behalf of the Commissioner, BECC invites Tenders from eligible tenderers for the construction works as detailed below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1	Comprehensive Developments of Drains and roads in Swathanthra nagara and Surrounding areas at census block number 89/1 and 89/2 of census 2011 in Ward no.92, Basavanapura. (SC Reserve). Amount put to tender : Rs. 99.99 lakhs. EMD : Rs. 99,990/-.
2	Comprehensive Developments of Drains and roads in Muniswamappa Layout, Priyanka nagar and Surrounding areas at census block number 71 of census 2011 in Ward no.92, Basavanapura. Amount put to tender : Rs. 99.98 lakhs. EMD : Rs. 1,99,960/-.
3	Comprehensive Developments of Drains and roads in Vinayaka 2 layout, Jyothi Nagar and Surrounding areas at census block number 103 and 104 of census 2011 in Ward no.92, Basavanapura (CAT-IIA Reserve). Amount put to tender : Rs. 99.98 lakhs. EMD : Rs. 99,980/-.
4	Comprehensive Developments of Drains and roads in Parvathi Nagar and Surrounding areas at census block number 103 and 104 of census 2011 in Ward no.92, Basavanapura (CAT-IIA Reserve). Amount put to tender : Rs. 99.99 lakhs. EMD : Rs. 99,990/-.
5	Comprehensive Developments of Drains and roads in Gayathri Layout, Masjid cross roads and Surrounding ar as at census block number 86 of census 2011 in Ward no.92, Basavanapura. Amount put to tender : Rs. 99.99 lakhs. EMD : Rs. 1,99,940/-.
6	Comprehensive Developments of Drains and roads in Hale Devasandra and Surrounding areas at census block number 97 of census 2011 in Ward no.92, Basavanapura. Amount put to tender : Rs. 99.99 lakhs. EMD : Rs. 1,99,980/-.

Period of completion : **6 months.**
Calendar of Events: (1) Tender documents may be downloaded from KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> (2) Last Date for Submission for Queries : **22.07.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs.** (3) Date and Time for Pre-Bid Meeting : **22.07.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.** (4) Last Date and Time for Submission of Tenders: **27.07.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.** (5) Date and Time for Opening of Technical Bid: **28.07.2026 at 16:30 Hrs.** (6) Date and Time for Opening of Financial Bid : **29.07.2026 at 16:00 Hrs.** Further details may be obtained from the above office during office hours or from KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>
Sd/- Executive Engineer, K.R. Pura Division, BECC

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Website: www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in, Email: cos@ner.railnet.gov.in
Tender Notice No.-07, Date 15-07-2026

Invitation of tenders through e-Procurement System

Principal Chief Material Manager, North Eastern Railway, Gorakhpur-273012 and on behalf of the President of India, invites tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items. Complete description of the item and other condition are available on website www.ireps.gov.in

Item No.	Tender Number	Due on	Brief Description of Stores	Qty.
1	22261811A	07/09/2026	Maintenance kit 03 for Earthing equipment etc	1649 Nos.
2	22260745	07/09/2026	Hanger for Bogie Bolster etc.	14276 Nos.
3	28260904	07/09/2026	Flaw check cleaner/Remover etc	14621 Sets.
4	22260767	31/08/2026	Air Brake Hose Coupling complete etc	9248 Nos.
5	26260240B	31/08/2026	Vinyl coated upholstery Fabric etc	209600 Mtr
6	22262227	24/08/2026	Must change item for brake etc	285 Sets.
7	22261107	24/08/2026	Primary Vertical Damper for FIAT etc	5462 Sets.
8	22252343A	24/08/2026	PNEUMATIC CONTROL UNIT etc	139 Nos.
9	22261058	18/08/2026	Lavatory door complete (LH) etc	497 Nos.
10	28260938	17/08/2026	DOWSIL 3-0100 RTV Automotive sealant etc	7000 liter
11	22262228	17/08/2026	SPHEROLASTIC RUBBER BEARING etc	306 Nos.
12	22261490	12/08/2026	LHB Hand Brake cylinder etc	43 Nos.
13	28261356	12/08/2026	PU paint kit for LHB Rajdhani Coaches etc	835 Sets.
14	22262187	11/08/2026	Gangway Bridge Mounting etc	1074 Nos.
15	28266105	10/08/2026	Inj. Ranibizumab 1.65 mg.	600 Nos.
16	30261184	10/08/2026	4.5 Kw Under slung Constant Voltage etc	327 Nos.
17	21260138	10/08/2026	HYDRAULIC OIL SHELL TELLUS etc	20900 liter
18	22262438A	10/08/2026	Elastomeric Pad (TPE) Spring Pad) etc	129 Sets.
19	29261024	08/08/2026	Base Assembly Set for IRS EPM-143 mm etc	1568 Sets.
20	29261065	08/08/2026	Set of Main Gear Assembly etc	2223 Sets.
21	29265001A	05/08/2026	48 Fibre Armoured Optical Fibre Cable etc	823 KM
22	22261524	05/08/2026	Speed Sensor to KBI part no. STN 31450/205A18U etc	346 Nos.
23	21260121	04/08/2026	BRAKE CALIPER GREASE STARBURAGS etc	1008 Kg
24	30261098A	03/08/2026	Hermetically sealed scroll Compressor etc	195 Nos.
25	29265002C	03/08/2026	24 Fibre Armoured Optical Fiber Cable etc	245 KM
26	30260518A	03/08/2026	Hermitically Sealed Scroll Compressor etc	192 Nos.
27	29261035	03/08/2026	Punching Item set used in Contact group etc	46667 Sets.
28	22261947A	03/08/2026	Spherolastic silent block for CBC etc	893 Nos.
29	30261204	03/08/2026	Return Air filter as per RDSO etc	2586 Nos.
30	30261095	03/08/2026	500Amp, 750V, Inter Vehicular (IV) Coupler unit etc	451 Sets.
31	29261025	03/08/2026	Set of Main Gear Assembly For I.R.S. etc.	375 Sets.
32	22261960	03/08/2026	Manual Uncoupling Device etc	392 Nos.
33	24260852	31/07/2026	Gear wheel 58 teeth etc	52 Nos.
34	29245186A	03/08/2026	Supply of Multi Section Digital etc	As per NIT CPRO/S-3

Principal Chief Material Manager, Gorakhpur
Never travel on roof and foot boards.

WINDOW NOTICE
THRISSUR CORPORATION
ctetrichur@gmail.com, Ph no: 0487-2422420

File No: PW2-277830/25

Dt.16.07.2026

INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Thirissur Municipal Corporation is Inviting EOI for 5 MLD Decentralized Sewerage Scheme (STP at Kokkala with Septage Co-treatment & Associated Network including house connections)

Bid submitting available from :- 17.07.2026 to 07.08.2026 4 PM

Opening date :- 10.08.2026, 11 AM

E-Tender ID : :2026_LSGD_860624_1

For more details login to tenders.kerala.gov.in

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Thirissur Corporation.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

No. 42/LP/NS/42265719 Dt. 14.07.2026

E-Tender

Dy CMM/NWR/Ajmer, acting for and behalf of the president of india invites E-tender against tender no. 42265719 Dt. 13.07.2026 Closing Dt. 12.08.2026 at 14:25 hrs. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and times only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offers received shall be ignored. 1. **Description of work:** VB TRAIN SET SIDWAL MAKE HVAC SPARE COMPRISING OF 46 ITEMS AS PER ANNEXURE -"A" 2. **Quantity:** 01 Set; 3. **Date & time for submission of tender:** Submission of E-Tender up to 12.08.2026 at 14.25 Hrs. 4. **Website participant:** www.ireps.gov.in 1019-AM/26

Please join us on /NWR/Railways

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer (Const.), North-Western Railway, Bikaner for and on behalf of the President of India, invites open e-Tenders under **Two packet system** for the following works:-
Tender No. NWR-SC-BKN-02-2026-27-EPG; 2. **Name of the work with its location:** Major Upgradation of Bikaner Railway Station of North Western Railway on EPC mode. 3. **Approx. cost of the work:** Rs. 455,24,83,844.05; 4. **Bid Security to be deposited:** Rs.9,10,49,700.00; 5. **Date for submission of e-tender:** On 14.08.2026 upto 15.00 hrs; 6. **Date, time and place of pre bid conference:** On 23.07.2026 at 11.30 AM in the office of Chief Administrative officer (Construction), Head Quarter North-Western Railway, Jagatpura, Jaipur (Rajasthan) 7. **Details and particulars of website where e-tender can be seen & filled up.** www.ireps.gov.in; 8. **Official email address:** dycecbkn@gmail.com; **Note :-** 1. No manual tender will be accepted. 2. The Bid Security shall be deposited in cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a Scheduled Commercial Bank of India or as mentioned in the tender documents. The bank guarantee bond should be issued in favour of FA & CAO/Construction, North Western Railway Jaipur otherwise tender will not be considered

1021-AM/26
Please join us on /NWR/Railways

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
Tamil Nadu Women Employment and Safety Project (TNWeSafe)

454/Schemes/2024

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

Dated 16/07/2026

e-Tender is invited by The Project Director, Tamil Nadu Women Employment and Safety (TNWESAFE) Project, towards the **"Hiring of a consultancy agency to conduct a study and develop a framework to guide the preparation of Women's Quality Employment Plan (WQEP)"**. The tender document (RFP) can be downloaded free of cost at <https://tntenders.gov.in> from **16.07.2026 at 5.00 PM** onwards. Online bid submission starts from **16.07.2026, at 5.00 PM** onwards and ends on **31.07.2026, at 05.00 PM**. Offline bids will not be accepted. For details and particulars, please visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>

DIPR/2306/TENDER/2026

Project Director

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Open E-Tender Notice

DRM (W)'s Office, BHOPAL, Date: 15.07.2026

Sr. DEN/CO/WCR, Bhopal acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders against following works, upto 15.30 hours on the dates mentioned against each tender. The complete tender documents and detail information regarding tender, is available on the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. NIT can also be seen on the notice board of DRM (W)/WCR/ Bhopal office. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders. For any correction, in these tenders, if necessary, corrigendum will be uploaded on website prior to tender opening date and copy of corrigendum will be placed on Notice Board of this office, which may be seen upto the date of tender opening. Tenderers are requested to offer their rates and submit tenders according to the provisions of GST ACT 2017. **Sr.No.-01-NIT No.-26-27-N-19-61, Date-09/07/2026, Name of work including Location-** Bina-Guna section: Provision of LHS in lieu of Manned LC No. 37 (Non interlocked) at KM 1042/5-6 between HPKA (Hinotia Pipalkhera)-ASKN (Ashoknagar station) Section. (Balance Work of Approach wall & drain.). **Published cost of tender (Rs.)-**1,60,25,852.34, **Earnest Money-**3,20,500.00, **Completion period-**12 Months. **Last date for submitting tender-**31/07/2026, **Sr.No.-02-NIT No.-26-27-N-20-62, Date-09/07/2026, Name of work including Location-**Part (A) Bhopal Division: Provision of One bay Cover Over Platforms of 13 stations in Bina-Guna section Mahadeokhedi (MDVK), Semarkheri (SRKI), Kanjia (KXB), Guneru Bamori (GVB), Pipraigaon (PIA), Rahatvas (RTWS), ORR, Hinotia Pipalkhera (HPKA), Ratikheda (RIKA), Shadhoraagaon (SHDR), Pilighata (PIGT), Pagara (PGA) and Maban (MABN) stations. (With Electrical Work) Part (B) Heavy repair to old running room at Guna. **Published cost of tender (Rs.)-**3,31,97,398.05, **Earnest Money-**6,64,000.00, **Completion period-**12 Months. **Last date for submitting tender-**31/07/2026, **Name of work including Location-**Bhopal Division:- Bina- Provision of Boundary Wall to protect encroachment in Railway Land in East and West colony.**Published cost of tender (Rs.)-**2,29,52,179.79, **Earnest Money-**4,59,100.00, **Completion period-**12 Months, **Last date for submitting tender-**31/07/2026, **Sr.No.-04-NIT No.-26-27-N-22-64, Date-10/07/2026, Name of work including Location-**Yard Drainage improvement work in Yards (Bareth, Kalhar, Mandi Bamora, Kurwai Kailthora, Bina) of Bina Sub-Division. **Published cost of tender (Rs.)-**6,81,46,135.65, **Earnest Money-**13,62,900.00, **Completion period-**18 Months, **Last date for submitting tender-**03/08/2026.

(SD.)
DRM (W) BPL
West Central Railway, BHOPAL

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CANTONMENT BOARD
St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram
Ministry of Defence, Government of India
Chennai-600 016.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for information to the General Public that the Ministry of Defence, Government of India, Delhi vide ID No.2(2)/2018-D(Q&C) dated 10.12.2019 and the Director General, Defence Estates, Government of India, Ministry of Defence, Delhi, vide Letter No.76/67/Expert Committee/C/DE/2018 Vol IV FMS ID 66645, dated 11.12.2019 have issued certain guidelines and exemptions pertaining to provisions contained in the Section 235(2) of the Cantonments Act, 2006 over structural stability of the building, repair works to authorized buildings for which notice for sanction of erection under Section 235 of the Cantonments Act, 2006 may not be required for the works mentioned in above Letter. The details can be obtained from this Office during working hours. The same is available in the Cantonment Board website <https://stm.cantt.gov.in/>.

Sd/-
(BHUPATI ROHIT, I.D.E.S)
Chief Executive Officer
St. Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram
Cantonment Board

No.STM/Works/1/1474
Dated: 13-07-2026.

A CH-CHE



The Hindu.

From Page One

Wangchuk weak, Delhi HC orders monitoring

The petition sought urgent intervention to safeguard Mr. Wangchuk's health. Mr. Saini sought intervention “even if forcibly” to save Mr. Wangchuk's life.

Mr. Wangchuk has been on a hunger strike demanding Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over issues concerning the country's education system. On Thursday, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)'s protest site filled up substantially as more high-profile figures arrived at Jantar Mantar to register their support.

Three student supporters from the Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist)'s student outfit, the All India Students' Association (AISA), were also at a critical stage of their concurrent hunger strike, Sai Balaji, a former AISA president, said in a statement. “Aameen is at risk of a hypovolemic shock due to dehydration, Neha's RBS levels hover around a dangerous 49 mg/dl and Manish has lost more than 10% of body mass,” Mr. Balaji said.

While there have been calls for Mr. Wangchuk to end his hunger strike, he has remained resolute in continuing it.

(With inputs from Soibam Rocky Singh)

‘Breach’ unrelated to nuclear activity: govt.

NPCIL said in a statement late on Wednesday that the drawings and technical documents reportedly leaked relate only to the Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) contract for the Common Services-Balance of Plant (BoP) package of Kudankulam Nuclear Power Project (KKNPP) Units 3 and 4, which was awarded to Reliance Infrastructure Ltd. through a public tender in 2018.

The corporation stressed that these facilities are conventional in nature, comparable to those used in thermal power plants and other process industries, and are not connected to nuclear safety or nuclear security systems. BoP refers to supporting infrastructure, auxiliary systems, and components required to make the plant operational and excludes the core generating equipment.

The government-run utility said it had shared only indicative drawings and technical specifications with bidders as part of the tendering process. Based on these inputs, Reliance Infrastructure prepared detailed engineering drawings in consultation with the original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), which were subsequently reviewed and accepted by NPCIL after verifying that they met the project's technical specifications.

After commissioning two 1,000 Mwe VVER reactors, the KKNPP is constructing four more similar units with Russian technical know-how at Kudankulam, which is all set to house India's biggest nuclear park with reactors generating 6,000 MW nuclear power.

According to a Reuters report, over 19,000 highly sensitive files dating between 2016 and mid-2025 and linked to KKNPP's engineering blueprints on control, cooling and ventilation systems, list of vendors and suppliers supplying equipment, operational files on meeting records, reviews of joint inspection by the Indian and Russian engineers, insurance policies, etc., had been accessed by well-known ransomware group World Leaks. The leak reportedly originated from a server hosted by third party provider, Yotta, belonging to the plant's contractor Anil Ambani's Reliance Group, which has admitted that “partial breach” had happened.

11.21 lakh clear NEET re-test; women excel

Nineteen candidates crossed the 700-mark threshold. The examination was administered in 13 languages. Uttar Pradesh generated the highest number of successful candidates with over 1.7 lakh qualifiers while Lakshadweep recorded 43.

The top 17 ranks (above 705 marks) were distributed across eight States – Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Bihar, Tamil Nadu, and Telangana.

Regional toppers included Jigmet Yangchan Lamo (Ladakh, 530 marks), Dhruv Tripathi (Andaman and Nicobar Islands, 606), and Fahmida Anees (Lakshadweep, 573).

Among the candidates who qualified, 5.12 lakh belonged to the Other Backward Classes-Non Creamy Layer category, followed by 2.91 lakh from General category; 1.59 lakh from Scheduled Caste category; 95,026 from General-Economically Weaker Sections; 63,716 from Scheduled Tribes; and 3,666 and 303 candidates respectively from Persons with Benchmark Disabilities and Persons with Disabilities categories.

The initial provisional answer keys were published and a public challenge window was opened for candidates to submit queries from June 25 to June 28.

Scanned copies of original OMR answer sheets and recorded candidate responses were hosted transparently online for direct verification from July 13 to July 15. The final verified answer key was released on Thursday, followed immediately by the final compilation and release of all-India scorecards.

“Actual merit lists, domicile verification, and counselling seat allocations fall under the purview of respective State Authorities and the Medical Counselling Committee (MCC),” the Ministry of Education stated in it's official release.

‘Third language should start in Class 6 and stop in Class 9’

SC judge asks Centre to not bring a third language in Class 9 as part of three-language scheme; T.N. says schools under Centre's Navodaya scheme are incompatible with two-language policy in State

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Supreme Court judge, Justice B.V. Nagarathna, made an oral appeal in open court to the government to not introduce a third language (R3) in Class 9 as part of the three-language scheme, saying it would be too stressful for children with Board exams just a year away.

She said a third language should be introduced in Class 6 and stopped in Class 9. “Third language should stop in Class 9, not start in Class 9,” Justice Nagarathna, heading a Division Bench, said. The pressure of the Class 10 Board exam starts as early as in Class 8, she added.

“Tell the Union of India to please not do this... Tell the government not to do it. Why introduce third language in Class 9? That is stressful. Why not Class 6?” Justice Nagarathna said.

The judge, who is in line to become the first woman Chief Justice of India as per the seniority norm, re-



called how, while she was in school, the teaching of lessons meant for Class 10 would begin in Class 8 itself. “And this was in 1976. You can just imagine what the pressure would be on children now,” she remarked.

‘Backdoor’ ploy

The Supreme Court was hearing petitions filed on the introduction of Navodaya schools in Tamil Nadu. The State government, during the previous Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) regime, had maintained that the schools envisioned under the Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya Scheme were “fundamentally incompatible” with the two-language policy followed in Tamil Nadu.

The State had, in earlier hearings, argued that the Navodaya scheme based on the three-language formula was a deviation from the mandate of the Tamil Nadu Tamil Learning Act, 2006.

The State had submitted that the three-language formula was considered a core pedagogical and administrative framework of the Navodaya scheme.

It required compulsory instruction in Hindi, English, and the mother tongue/regional language. The Tamil Nadu government had maintained that the imposition of the scheme was a “backdoor” ploy to make Hindi compulsory.

The apex court suggested that Tamil Nadu could have its “own education

system” without denying children the option of enrolling in Navodaya schools.

Justice Nagarathna pointed out that Hindi was not compulsory under the three-language scheme. “...All other States have Navodaya schools, then why not have them for the children of Tamil Nadu?” the judge asked senior advocate Hsari Priya Padmanabhan, Additional Advocate General for Tamil Nadu.

While the earlier DMK regime was of the opinion that the implementation of the Navodaya scheme was unnecessary in Tamil Nadu, which already provided quality residential education to meritorious students from rural and economically weaker sections, Ms. Padmanabhan adopted a cautious tone, saying the new government was engaged in talks about the Navodaya school scheme and needed some time to chalk out its course of action.

Acknowledging the intricacies of a “change of guard” in the State, the court gave time till August 11, the next date of hearing.

ED searches 13 places in ‘terror-funding and illegal infiltration’ case

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

The Enforcement Directorate on Thursday conducted searches at 13 locations across five States in connection with an alleged terror-funding and illegal infiltration network.

The case is linked to an FIR registered by the Anti-Terror Squad (ATS) of Uttar Pradesh. The searches were carried out in Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, West Bengal, and Maharashtra.

The ATS FIR pertains to an organised syndicate allegedly involved in facilitating the illegal infiltration of Rohingya and Bangladeshi nationals into India, arranging forged Indian identity documents.



Gold coins and ₹40 lakh in cash seized at Harora Al-Jamiatul Islamia Darul Uloom in Kolkata.

It also aided their rehabilitation in various parts of the country.

Investigation revealed a “deep-rooted financial network comprising certain charitable trusts registered under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act. They allegedly received substantial contributions from some United Kingdom-based entities.”

SC orders shifting of contempt pleas on ‘bulldozer justice’ to High Courts

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday passed a ‘standard order’ shifting contempt petitions alleging continued instances of ‘bulldozer justice’ to the State High Courts, reasoning it was too unwieldy to hear them all, and many would require an enquiry into facts.

The move comes in less than two years after the apex court declared illegal demolitions conducted by States on private properties and homes, especially of people accused in criminal cases, as an “arbitrary use of power”.

The court's November 2024 judgment termed the “chilling sight of a bulldozer demolishing a building,



The move comes less than two years after the SC declared illegal demolitions by States as ‘arbitrary use of power’. PTI

when authorities have failed to follow the basic principles of natural justice and have acted without adhering to the principle of due process” as a lawless state of affairs where “might was right”.

The judgment issued a series of directions mandating due process before demolition and stressing

Bombay HC directs Centre to file reply to Kunal Kamra's plea

Chinmay Gaiikwad
MUMBAI

The Bombay High Court on Thursday directed the Union government to file an affidavit by July 29 in response to a petition filed by stand-up comedian Kunal Kamra. The plea challenges the constitutional validity of the Sahyog Portal and the 2025 amendment to Rule 3(1)(d) of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021. Mr. Kamra has contended that the provisions enable content take-downs without safeguards.

A Division Bench of Acting Chief Justice Ravindra Ghuge and Justice Gautam Ankhad scheduled the matter for hearing on August 14. The court granted Mr. Kamra time till August 6 to file his rejoinder to the government's reply.

Senior Advocate Navroz Seervai, appearing for Mr. Kamra, submitted that the Centre had not filed its affidavit despite being granted opportunities. He said the matter pertained to Article 19(1)(a) and concerned freedom of speech and expression.

Mr. Kamra's petition argues that the mechanism creates a parallel content-

The plea challenges the validity of the Sahyog Portal and the 2025 amendment to IT Rules, 2021

blocking framework that circumvents safeguards under Section 69A of the IT Act, 2000.

The plea contends that the Portal permits content blocking without prior notice to users, violating natural justice principles and the free speech guarantee under Article 19(1)(a).

It says Rule 3(1)(d) and the Portal are *ultra vires* the IT Act and contrary to the Supreme Court's ruling in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* (2015).

Mr. Kamra has also challenged the delegation of powers to States and departments to issue information-blocking directions, contending that such powers fall within the Centre's exclusive legislative domain under List I of the Seventh Schedule.

The Karnataka High Court, while deciding a challenge by X Corp, had held the Portal is not an instrument of censorship but ensures cooperation between intermediaries and government agencies.

petitions involves disputed facts which would require separate and in-depth enquiries, the Chief Justice said. The CJI even suggested separate Benches to hear the contempt pleas.

“...Maybe these are title disputes after all... In the High Courts, you may get a better opportunity to make your case on facts... Besides, if there is a violation of this judgment throughout the country, as you allege, can everybody come directly to the Supreme Court?” Justice S.V. Mohana said.

The court said High Courts could obtain the necessary records from district courts while deciding these pleas. Any interim protections granted by the Supreme Court in these cases would continue.

DGMA tells firms not to deploy sailors via Hormuz

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Directorate General of Maritime Administration (DGMA) has directed ship owners, ship managers and recruitment and placement service companies to avoid deploying Indian sailors on vessels travelling through the Strait of Hormuz.

The advisory came after the attacks on two vessels this week – *MT Al Bahiyah* and *MT Mombasa* – in the Strait of Hormuz. One Indian lost his life while another sustained injuries aboard *MT Al Bahiyah*. On *MT Mombasa*, nine Indian nationals were injured.

The government on Tuesday had asked the shipping authority to set up a dashboard for providing real-time information about Indian seafarers on each vessel operating in the region, irrespective of the ship's flag.

Fourth Trinamool Rajya Sabha MP quits; those facing pressure must leave party, says Mamata

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

A day after Mamata Banerjee's long-time aide Madan Mitra deserted her and joined the rebel camp of MLAs, another high-profile exit rocked the party with Rajya Sabha MP Koel Mallick resigning on Thursday.

Ms. Mallick, a well-known actor, met Union Minister and BJP leader Bhupendra Yadav in New Delhi. She was sworn in as an MP three months ago and is the fourth Trinamool Rajya Sabha member to quit after the party lost the Assembly polls in May.

Following the exit, Ms. Banerjee said that those facing pressure from Central agencies should leave with “all their belongings” before July 21.

“I request those who are facing various pressures from the ED, CBI or BJP to leave before July 21. Leave



Mamata Banerjee

with all your belongings,” the Trinamool chairperson said on social media.

Ms. Banerjee, who is facing one of the biggest challenges of her political life, said those who remain with her will be her “greatest strength”. “They will build the future. If we could begin a fresh in 1997 (when she left Congress and set up Trinamool), we could certainly do so again in 2026,” she said.

“BJP leaders say they will erase our name and symbol. But many political parties have changed their

names and symbols over time, while their identity has endured. You may change a name through the force of power, but you cannot erase an ideology or a direction,” she added.

Ms. Banerjee, who has exhorted her supporters to join the Martyrs' Day rally on July 21, alleged that the administration and the police are pressuring people to stay away from the event. “I know the police are telling people not to come and threatening to stop them. I appeal to the administration to remain neutral,” she said.

‘Things will change’

She said the rebels are doing everything with the “backing from Delhi”. “Remember, life is long. If things start to shake in Delhi, the situation here will change,” she said, adding that it does not matter how many MPs are bought.

‘Roads to frontline key in modern warfare’

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday underlined the critical role of strategic infrastructure in future conflicts, asserting that roads, tunnels, airfields and ports will remain indispensable despite the induction of advanced weapons and cutting-edge military platforms into the armed forces.

Addressing the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) Strategic Infrastructure Conclave in New Delhi, Mr.

Singh said, “Sometimes, the first front of a war is not at the border itself, but on the road that leads our soldiers to the frontline. The person who builds that road is as vital a guardian of national security as the soldier who stands at the border,” he said.

Mr. Singh cited landmark projects such as the Atal Tunnel, Umling La Pass road and the Sela Tunnel as examples of the agency's engineering capabilities and commitment under some of the world's harshest conditions.

Ms. Bhumi Bala, Manipal Hospital No. MH011333953, 6 years is Diagnosed to be suffering from S/P Antegrade Prolapse on 04/10/2023. Large PM Maligned VSD BD. No RVOT Gradient, free PR, confluent branch PAS good sized, severe PAH (likely), Tiny collaterals. She requires to undergo Redo Intra Cardiac Repair. The Estimated cost of the surgery is Rs.7,50,000/-.

Please send donation however small by Cheque/D.D/M.O Fav. **Save Poor Lives** A/c Ms. Bhumi Bala. **Our A/c Details:** S/B A/c No. 20000913487. S.B.I. R.A.Puram, IFSC CODE: SBIN0001855. Please Donate by G-pay No.9884607377, UPI Id: savepoorlives@oksb. Donations are exempted under 80G of I.T.ACT.

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APPEAL

Cong. to 'strongly oppose' move to reintroduce delimitation Bill

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge along with leaders Jairam Ramesh, P. Chidambaram and others during the meeting. ANI

Bills on FCRA, *Vandemataram* listed for Monsoon Session

Panel flags autonomy risks under VBSA Bill

“The committee expressed apprehension that concentration of extensive regulatory powers in a single central regulator could lead to bureaucratic or ideological overreach, thereby affecting the institutional autonomy presently available under the existing UGC framework,” the draft report said.

On the draw



SC verdicts say state has the duty to preserve life of a person on indefinite fast

NEWS ANALYSIS

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

**Hunger strikes
are neither
unconstitutional nor
barred under any
law in the country**

Opposition leaders, film industry members rally behind Sonam Wangchuk

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

Life at risk: AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal with Activist Sonam Wangchuk in New Delhi on Thursday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

gram. Actors Sonakshi Sinha and Fatima Sana Shaikh too voiced their supported.

PM speaks to Amir of Qatar, condoles loss

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

TELANGANA POLLUTION CONTROL BOARD
 A-63, Industrial Estate, Sanathnagar, Hyderabad-500018

e-TENDER NOTICE

Tender No. 363/TGPBC/IL/ABIP/PGC/CAQMS/2026 **Date: 15.07.2026**

The Board is invited online to receive bids from Interested Parties (IPs) for the supply of O&M/ S Bidders for Supply, Installation, Operation & Maintenance of Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring System (CAQMS)-13 Nos. The tender document can be downloaded from <https://tender.telangana.gov.in> The last date for submission of e-tender is 20.07.2026 at 03.00 PM.

DIPR R.O. No. 324/PPC-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 **SD/- MEMBER SECRETARY**
TGPBC, HYDERABAD

INDIA bloc will take a collective call on delimitation: Raut

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Sanjay Raut

The Congress said that there were questions about the fate of the Maha Vikas Aghadi in Maharashtra.

KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE
 O/o The Chief Engineer (S.C.M.) & C.S.E., Vidyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram.
E-Tender ID No. 2026_KSEB_858520_1
PAC: Rs.13,30,76,900/-, Last Date: 31.07.2026, 05.00 pm.
O/o The Deputy Chief Engineer, Civil Circle, Pallom, Kottayam.
Tender ID No. GEM/2026/B/7766634, PAC: Rs. 2,96,31,360/-
Last Date: 31.07.2026, 05.00 pm.
 Documents available in website <https://gem.gov.in>
CORRIGENDUM
O/o The Executive Engineer, Generation Division, Poringalkuthu, Thrissur.
E-Tender ID No. 2026_KSEB_854110_1, PAC: Rs.1,06,52,000/-
Last Date: 22.07.2026, 03.00 pm.
 Visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in and www.kseb.in
Ref: PR/MC/1/E622 - E-tender/2026



BHARAT DYNAMICS LIMITED

(A Govt. of India Enterprise, Ministry of Defence)

GACHIBOWLI, HYDERABAD - 500 032

Ref:BDL/CC/OT/001/2026-27
Dt : 17.07.2026

e-PROCUREMENT ABRIDGED TENDER NOTICE

Inviting Indigenous Competitive Bidding

Sl. NO.	Tender ID	Description
1	66967	Notice to participate against Tender ID:66967 for Shackles Mechanism

Please visit website <https://bdltenders.abcdprocure.com>, select online tenders on dashboard and register your details. Bids shall be submitted online only, "corrigendum if any shall be issued through our e-portal only and not in Newspapers".

"Bidders are Requested to apply for online Vendor Registration in BDL website <https://bdl-india.in> registration-contractors prospects.

ADDITIONAL GENERAL MANAGER (Corp Comm)

INBRIEF



Modi set to flag off India's first hydrogen-powered train today

In a push towards sustainable transport, modern healthcare, and advanced connectivity, Prime Minister Narendra Modi is scheduled to visit Haryana, and Punjab on Friday, where he will unveil initiatives valued at over ₹25,000 crore. The highlight of the visit will be the flagging-off of India's first-ever hydrogen-powered fuel cell train at Jind in Haryana. Designed and integrated indigenously, this 10-coach train is among the world's longest and most powerful hydrogen-fuelled passenger trainsets, powered by a 3,200 horsepower (HP) propulsion system. Unlike traditional trains, it generates its own electricity onboard through a chemical reaction between hydrogen and atmospheric oxygen, leaving behind water vapour.

PF interest credited to all 34 crore accounts on July 15

For the first time, interest for the financial year 2025-26 for the deposits in Provident Fund accounts was credited to all 34 crore accounts in one go on July 15. Union Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya had earlier said that after implementing the Centralised IT Enabled Services project for updating the database of the EPFO, the interest amounting to over ₹1.44 lakh crore would be credited to accounts of 34 crore members. The Union Finance Ministry had recently approved the recommendation of the EPFO's Central Board of Trustees to provide interest at the rate of 8.25%.

'Frame policy for release of aged, terminally ill inmates'

The Supreme Court orders States and UTs to draft uniform policy for premature release of such prisoners within three months in coordination with the respective State Legal Services Authorities

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday directed all States and Union Territories to put in place, within three months, a uniform policy governing the premature release of elderly and terminally ill prisoners, observing that such inmates are entitled to a humane and time-bound mechanism for remission or early release on compassionate grounds.

A Bench comprising Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta directed that every State policy must clearly lay down the eligibility criteria and procedural framework governing such releases.

"All States and Union Territories shall, within a period of three months from the date of this judgment, formulate and notify a comprehensive policy for early or premature release of prisoners who are of advanced age and/or are terminally ill. Such policy shall be framed in consultation with the respective State Legal Services Authorities so as to ensure institutional coordination and



Joint approach: The policy must ensure institutional coordination to identify eligible prisoners, the court said. ISTOCK

effective identification of eligible prisoners," the Bench said.

NALSA petition

The directions were issued while hearing a petition filed by the National Legal Services Authority (NALSA), which, based on inspections conducted in prisons across the country, pointed to the lack of a common framework for the premature release of aged and terminally ill prisoners. The petition contended that facilitating the release of such inmates would not only address a humanitarian concern but also help reduce overcrowding in prisons. The court directed that

every policy must incorporate a clear and uniform definition of "terminal illness". It permitted the authorities to draw upon the definition contained in the *Handbook on Prisoners with Special Needs* published by the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC), which describes terminal illness as "a condition where there is no reasonable medical possibility that the patient's condition will not continue to degenerate and result in death".

It also directed the States and Union Territories to constitute independent medical boards to assess and certify cases of terminal illness or ad-

vanced medical vulnerability in accordance with uniform eligibility criteria while considering applications for remission of prison sentences.

To facilitate the implementation of its directions, the Bench directed the Union government, in coordination with the National Informatics Centre (NIC), to provide the States and Union Territories with technical assistance, digital infrastructure, software support and training.

Compliance affidavits

The Bench directed the Centre, States and Union Territories to file compliance affidavits within six months, detailing the number of prisoners identified under the policy, those granted premature release, and those whose cases remain under consideration. The matter has been listed on January 19, 2027.

The petition had pointed out that India's prisons had an occupancy rate of 131% as of December 31, 2022, and that terminally ill and elderly inmates often require specialised care that prison authorities are ill-equipped to provide.

NITI Aayog suggests ₹50,000-crore fund for biotech growth

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

A NITI Aayog road map has proposed creating a ₹50,000-crore BioEconomy Growth Fund, a dedicated production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for biomanufacturing and six national biotechnology missions as part of an ambitious strategy to transform India into one of the world's top three biotechnology powers by 2035.

The report, "Roadmap for building India as a leading bioeconomy powerhouse by 2035", released on Thursday, says India should move beyond the broad framework laid out under the Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment (BioE3) policy and adopt a mission-mode execution strategy backed by new financing, regulatory reforms and cross-ministerial governance. It targets expanding India's bioeconomy from \$195.3 billion in 2025 to \$691 billion by 2035 and \$2.6 trillion by 2047, while creating over 30 million high-value jobs.

"The goal is not to just research but to build globally competitive biotechnology companies," said Debjani Ghosh, Distinguished Fellow, NITI

Aayog, at the launch. The centrepiece of the recommendation is a proposed ₹50,000-crore fund for 2026-35 to bridge the biotechnology sector's "valley of death" – the gap between proof-of-concept research and commercial-scale manufacturing. The fund would provide blended finance, equity-risk instruments, viability-gap funding and infrastructure support for biomanufacturing, advanced therapeutics, synthetic biology, fermentation technologies and diagnostics.

The roadmap also recommends launching six National BioMissions with clearly identified lead Ministries and measurable outcomes by 2035. These include GeneIndia for affordable gene and cell therapies, AgriBio 2.0 for climate-resilient gene-edited crops and biological farm inputs, BioX Foundry to commercialise synthetic biology innovations, One Health Grid for integrated surveillance of infectious diseases and antimicrobial resistance, Marine Biotechnology to expand seaweed cultivation and marine bioproducts, and BioPharma-Next to establish India as a global hub for biologics, biosimilars and AI-enabled drug discovery.

After ambushes, CRPF tells forces in Manipur to use armoured vehicles

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

In the wake of two ambushes on Assam Rifles personnel in Manipur and Nagaland, the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) units deployed in Manipur have been instructed to use only armoured vehicles for movement and to avoid sudden or unplanned deployments, a senior government official said on Thursday.

In June, the CRPF inducted two battalions of the Commando Battalion for Resolute Action (CoBRA), a specialised unit raised for anti-Maoist operations, in the northeastern State to step up operations against armed groups, dismantling of bunkers, and recovery of weapons.

At least 100 armoured vehicles have been sent to Manipur in the past two



Army personnel carry the coffins of two Assam Rifles personnel, who were killed in an attack in Manipur on July 6. PTI

months, the official said. The CRPF is the largest Central security force deployed in Manipur, with 200 companies comprising around 20,000 personnel.

In addition to the CRPF, the State has around 100 Border Security Force companies, comprising approximately 10,000 personnel, and about 26,000

personnel from the Assam Rifles and the Indian Army deployed across the region.

The CoBRA battalions have been given pre-induction training in crowd management as the State often witnesses obstruction by locals, especially women, during security-related operations.

"We have advised the

personnel to avoid any sudden movement for administrative or operational reasons. They have also been asked to take action against armed miscreants, anyone found with a gun is to be arrested or fired upon, if they do not surrender," said the official.

As the ethnic conflict between the Kuki and Meitei people in Manipur has now expanded to tensions between Kukis and the Naga people, plans are afoot to deploy the CoBRA battalions in the hill districts of Churachandpur, Kangpokpi, and Ukhrul, another government official said. While Churachandpur and Kangpokpi are Kuki-Zo-dominated districts, Ukhrul is a Naga-majority area.

The ethnic violence, which erupted on May 3, 2023, has claimed the lives of 300 people so far.

Two dead, several injured as lakhs attend Jagannath Rath Yatra in Puri

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Two persons were killed and several injured after a crowd surge on *Badadanda*, the wide road in front of the 12th century Shree Jagannath Temple in Puri, during the pulling of chariots on the occasion of the annual Rath Yatra on Thursday.

The stampede-like situation occurred near the Marichikote Chowk when devotees were pushed aside to make way for an ambulance moving through the crowd.

Amid the massive rush, several people fell over one another, leading to injuries. The injured were rushed to the District Headquarters Hospital in Puri, many with fractures in their hands and legs.

Two persons were declared dead at the hospital.



An ambulance stuck amid a crowd surge during the Rath Yatra in Puri on Thursday. PTI

One of the deceased was identified as Anil Dash (35), while the identity of the other is yet to be ascertained.

Around a hundred devotees were admitted for treatment, sources in the hospital said. While most were declared out of danger, the condition of two of them remained critical.

"The overall conduct of

the festival remained peaceful, orderly and well managed. There was no incident of stampede or any systemic breakdown of crowd management," the Chief Minister's Office said, while confirming the deaths of two persons.

"I am deeply saddened by the loss of lives in the stampede at *Badadanda* during Rath Yatra. I pray for the eternal peace of the departed souls and for the swift recovery of the injured," former Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik said.

"In this hour of grief, all Biju Janata Dal workers will extend full cooperation to assist those affected. I hope the State government ensures better crowd management for the safety and convenience of devotees," Mr. Patnaik added in a post on social media platform X.

Earlier in the day, lakhs of devotees braved incessant rain to throng the 3 km-long *Badadanda*, connecting the Shree Jagannath Temple with the Gundicha Temple. However, the chariots could not reach the Gundicha Temple and were halted midway. The pulling of the chariots is scheduled to resume on Friday.

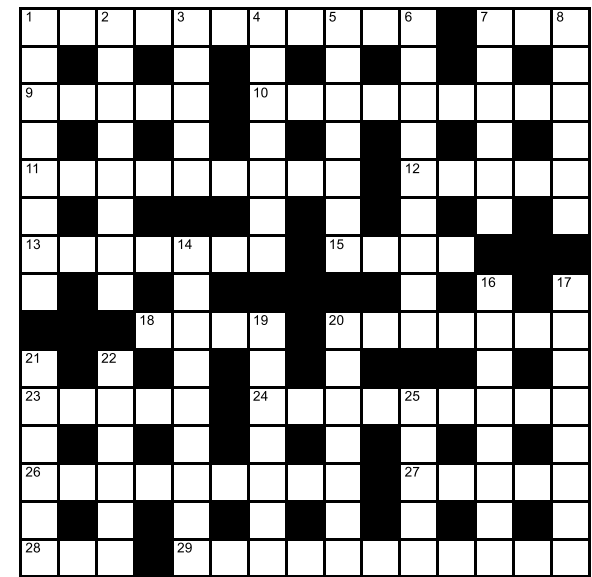
THE HINDU

CROSSWORD+ 14848

(set by Afterdark)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY



- 13 Viscous black liquid layer over lake at Ajmer outskirts (4,3)
- 15 Course beginners in Tamil indicate difficulty & ennui (4)
- 18 Victim, a mother saved by a religious leader (4)
- 20 Short lady initially cried on everyone's hate (7)
- 23 Central forecast on regulation (5)
- 24 Amanda, Laila, Matilda contributing to someone like 18 (5,4)
- 26 Cooked ribs, had half of port in a vessel (9)
- 27 Falls for medico at work, over heels ultimately (5)
- 28 Carpet is 50% bumpy (3)
- 29 One who repeats and reinforces opinions of coach Herb and me in a bad way (4,7)
- Down
- 1 Victory celebration at area and shortly at both sides of college (3,5)
- 2 Coaching for test covers university model only (8)
- 3 A vertical pipe at the floor corner is interred in the middle (5)
- 4 When in Paris, one doctor inserted tip of needle in parts (7)
- 5 Overlook end of the session, say 7-part lecture ending after 4th (7)
- 6 Wave patterns occurring twice a month, when sea in depth almost gets choppy (4,5)
- 7 Friend's girl lied; clipped the wings of a bird (6)
- 8 Nuisance of a lady, fricking heartless badger... (6)
- 14 ...I met in board programme (9)
- 16 Auditor and doctor buy a snack underground, perhaps (8)
- 17 Charlie prefers regularly procuring Pears soap, say (8)
- 19 Say, a holistic therapy's dumb, that nearly is silly (3,4)
- 20 Setter's icon making a comeback primarily composing for a musical (7)
- 21 Incense container at church at all directions but one on the right (6)
- 22 Whacking in disguise (6)
- 25 One's leaving a country to another (5)

- Across
- 1 Say, Lily's working to acquire new apparatus to disperse crowds (5,6)
- 7 Trap bachelor with girl (3)
- 9 Setback after Republican's order had repetitions (5)
- 10 Careless guru dead, ingesting some nightshade carelessly (9)
- 11 Brigadier designs a delivery mechanism (3,6)
- 12 Tremulous sound from other end of boat on stream (5)

SUDOKU

	2	1	3	8				
	5			9				
8	3					2		4
9	7				5			
		2				9		
			9				2	3
2	7						4	9
				4			6	
				1	2	3	7	

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

Solution to previous puzzle

C	L	M	S	N	D	C	P
A	V	A	R	I	C	E	T
R	D	C	E	R	P	U	E
E	M	I	N	E	N	T	
S	N	H	O	E	I	L	
S	U	G	A	R	B	E	E
O	I	S	U	S			
S	P	A	S	T	I	C	
E	L	T	U				
O	M	A	S	T	S	P	A
T	O	R	P	E	D	S	E
T	I	R	M	I	W	E	S
E	N	T	W	I	S	E	A
R	Y	E	R	T	B	C	R

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

1	3	7	2	4	6	8	9	5
4	9	5	8	1	7	6	3	2
2	6	8	3	5	9	7	4	1
9	5	4	6	3	2	1	7	8
3	1	6	4	7	8	5	2	9
8	7	2	5	9	1	3	6	4
7	8	3	1	2	4	9	5	6
6	2	9	7	8	5	4	1	3
5	4	1	9	6	3	2	8	7

INBRIEF



Windfall tax on diesel, ATF up, levy on petrol exports cut

The Centre has increased the windfall gains tax on exports of diesel and ATF, while lowering the levy on petrol for the fortnight beginning July 16. The Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) on diesel exports has been hiked to ₹15.5 a litre from ₹8.5 a litre. Similarly, SAED on ATF exports has been raised to ₹14.5 per litre from ₹7.5 per litre. However, the export duty on petrol has been cut to ₹2.5 per litre, from ₹4 per litre. PTI

Govt. lists Bill to replace FII tax exemption Ordinance

The Government listed a Bill it plans to table in the Monsoon Session of Parliament to replace June Ordinance which had exempted foreign institutional investors (FIIs) and the Bank of International Settlements (BIS) from capital gains tax and tax on interest from investment in government securities. It exempted from tax “interest on Government security and any capital gains arising from sale, exchange or transfer of such government security” by any FII and BIS. PTI

‘SP Group raises \$650 million via debut dollar debt sale’

Shapoorji Pallonji Group has raised \$650 million through its debut dollar debt issue, completing the dollar tranche of a delayed dual-currency bond fundraising, three sources aware of the matter said on Thursday. Mercury Finance, an SP Group company, sold three-year dollar securities at a yield of 14.50%, with an option to redeem them after one year, Reuters reported last Friday. BlackRock, the world’s largest asset manager, subscribed to these bonds. REUTERS

Moisture-absorbing nature of ethanol is contaminating fuel, claim petrol dealers

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

Petrol pump owners claim ethanol’s hygroscopic nature or affinity towards water is leading to contamination of E20 stock during monsoons and in coastal areas since existing underground storage tanks were designed for conventional petrol, not higher ethanol blends. The claims come amid viral videos on social media purportedly showing customers collecting what appears to be muddy water, rather than E20 from fuel dispensers.

One such video involved a Toyota Hycross car, which allegedly broke down shortly after refuelling. The automaker blamed fuel contamination as the car was E20 compliant. The maker of the video was later among at least 3 against whom an FIR was filed.

Three petrol pump owners shared concerns over the roll out of E20 with *The Hindu* on the condition of anonymity.

“The underground tanks that store fuel often have some amount of water due to ingress during rains or moisture or condensation or from the fuel tanker that brings petrol to the petrol pump. Now, when the water content in the entire E20 stock in underground tanks exceeds 0.5%, ethanol binds with water because of its hygroscopic nature or affinity for water. This results in phase separation where water-ethanol mixture settles at bottom of the tank, while the petrol forms a separate layer above,” said an industry veteran.

As fuel is drawn by the



Moisture absorption by ethanol may contaminate E20 fuel.

dispensing unit from the bottom of the underground tank, some vehicles may end up being dispensed with this water-rich mixture instead of E20.

“As a result, vehicles may not start, or break down after a distance. We come to know about contamination only when such customers come to us with complaints,” said a dealer.

Automotive experts say, such contaminated fuel can independently cause fuel injector to malfunction, poor driveability, fuel pump failures and in severe cases, engine damage.

Pump owners said the concerns were compounded in coastal areas where sub-soil water can further contaminate E20 if seals on underground tanks are not properly in place.

Fear of corrosion

A pump owner also feared underground tanks and pipelines made of mild steel could turn susceptible to corrosion because of ethanol’s tendency to absorb water, potentially adding to fuel contamination. Some said OMCs replaced seals and washers in petrol dispensing units with neoprene rubber in preparation for E20 rollout.

Revised CAFE III unveiled for stakeholder suggestions

The latest draft broadly mirrors the second circulated earlier this year by retaining a flatter weight-adjustment curve, thereby reducing the compliance advantage available to heavier SUVs

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The Centre on Thursday released the third draft of the fuel efficiency norms for passenger vehicles set to kick off from April 2027, proposing to recognise ethanol, compressed biogas (CBG) and other biofuels in compliance calculations by allowing manufacturers to claim specified reductions in declared tailpipe carbon dioxide emissions.

The latest draft has been released for stakeholder consultation until August 6 after a year-long battle between small and big car makers on compliance methodologies.

The latest draft broadly mirrors the second circulated earlier this year by retaining a flatter weight-ad-



Suggestions welcome: The latest draft has been released for stakeholder consultation until August 6.

justment curve than the original September 2025 proposal, thereby reducing the compliance advantage available to heavier SUVs. For cars which are below the industry average weight of 1,229 kg also, targets will be easier. The fleet

wide emission targets have been relaxed by about 21% compared to the original proposal of last year.

Manufacturers will be required to progressively improve the fuel efficiency of their fleets. The target fuel consumption is pro-

posed to be tightened from 3.996 litre per 100 km (94.76 gCO₂/km) in 2027-28 to 3.327 litres per 100 km (78.90 gCO₂/km) by 2031-32.

Unlike the current framework, compliance will be assessed over two blocks rather than annually – an initial three-year period followed by a second block of two years.

A key feature of the draft is the Carbon Neutrality Factors (CNFs), which recognise the lower lifecycle carbon footprint of renewable fuels such as ethanol, compressed biogas (CBG) and other biofuels.

Under the proposal, manufacturers will be allowed to reduce the declared tailpipe carbon dioxide emissions of their vehicles before compliance is assessed.

TechM’s Q1 net jumps 28% to ₹1,465 crore

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Tech Mahindra on Thursday posted a 28% increase in first quarter net profit to ₹1,465 crore.

Revenue grew almost 17.7% to ₹15,712 crore. It bagged new deals worth 1,078 million in the quar-

ter, a 33% rise. It reported cash and cash equivalent of ₹9,695 crore in Q1.

The firm indicated it may restart campus hiring as visibility into revenue outlook emerges. It’s headcount sequentially reduced by 863 in the first quarter ended June 30 to a total of 1,46,760.

Wipro Q1 net almost flat, to pay ₹2 dividend

Mini Tejaswi
BENGALURU

Wipro, India’s third lead technology firm, reported an almost flat net profit of ₹3,352 crore even as revenue rose in the June quarter. The sub-1% growth in net earnings came amid 11% year-on-year (YoY) increase in revenue to ₹24,479 crore.

Core IT services busi-

ness generated \$2.61 billion revenue, a 1.4% sequential dip and 1% growth YoY. Wipro booked total deals worth \$3.4 billion in the first quarter (Q1) of FY27, of which large contracts were valued at \$1.6 billion, a sequential increase of 12.9% in constant currency terms.

Wipro expects revenue from its IT Services business segment to be in the

CBDT will soon let you see data it has on your foreign assets, income

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) will soon allow taxpayers to see the information the tax department has received from abroad regarding their foreign assets and incomes, sources in the CBDT have said.

India receives information from more than 100 countries under the Automatic Exchange of Information (AEOI) framework. This information can include details relating to foreign bank accounts, custodial accounts, certain financial investments, interest, dividends and other specified financial income.

“As of now, information, as received, pertaining to calendar years 2022, 2023 and 2024 has been displayed in the Annual Information Statement (AIS) on the Income Tax e-Filing portal,” a source in the



The move is to promote voluntary tax compliance.

CBDT said. “Further, information for 2025 will be displayed in the AIS once it is received in the month of September or October 2026.”

The move is being done to enhance taxpayer services and promote voluntary tax compliance, the official added.

He added that the information being made available on the portal only reflects the information that the CBDT has received from its partner jurisdictions, and isn’t an exhaustive list.

Give new car that supports E20 to doctor, consumer panel orders

Shubhomov Sikdar
RAIPUR

The District Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission in Raipur ordered a car dealer to provide a new car and an added compensation of ₹1 lakh for mental harassment to a city-based doctor who complained that the vehicle sold to him broke down repeatedly.

Noting the complainant’s car did not have an E20 petrol-supported engine, the Commission directed the dealership to provide a model compatible with the said fuel composition.

The manufacturer, Maruti Suzuki, however, claimed the car was E20 compatible and said they would challenge the order.

In his appeal, Dr. Premraj Debta, a nephrologist, said the engine problem with his Maruti Grand Vitara Hybrid Zeta began in November 2024, five months after he bought it. When he took it back to the showroom, he was informed adulterated petrol affected the engine.

The problem arose few more times after which Dr. Debta found the dealership sold him an old model of the car. As matters escalated, the dealership refused a replacement or refund despite warranty.

In his appeal, Mr. Debta had sought ₹50 lakh for the hindrance caused to his work due to breakdowns.

Meanwhile, Maruti Suzuki claimed the car was fully equipped to handle E20 fuel and the Commission’s order did not reflect “several other relevant facts. The firm would take steps to challenge the order before a higher forum”.

राजस्थान सरकार
कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियंता
जलग्रहण विकास एवं भू संरक्षण विभाग जैसलमेर
(सी.एच.ओ. कोलोनी, ब्याकवार रोड, जैसलमेर- 345001) E-Mail: sewsc.jaisalmir@rajasthan.gov.in
क्रमांक: एक () जलविभाग/ एनएसएस/ 2.2/ जलसम/ 2026-27/789 दिनांक: 10/07/2026

Corrigendum (शुद्धि पत्र)
NIB No.-02/2026-27, NIB Code- WSC2627A0519
इस कार्यालय के ई निविदा पत्र क्रमांक 651-54 दिनांक 23.06.2026 द्वारा जारी निविदा क्रमांक 02/2026-27 में मुख्यमंत्री जल स्वावलम्बन अभियान 2.0 द्वितीय चरण अन्तर्गत स्वीकृत विभिन्न कार्यों हेतु जो निविदाई आमंत्रित की गई थी, उसमें अपरिहार्य कारणों से खोली दस्तावेज अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि 14.07.2026, 6.00 PM के स्थान पर 30.07.2026, 6.00 PM तक बढ़ाई जाती है। निम्ने दिनांक 31.07.2026, 11.00 AM को खोली जायेगी। निविदा को रोक नहीं पूर्ववत् रहेगी।
URN Details - WSC2627WSOB00852, WSC2627WSOB00853, WSC2627WSOB00854, WSC2627WSOB00855, WSC2627WSOB00856, WSC2627WSOB00857, WSC2627WSOB00858

(Koshal Chander Paliwal)
Superintending Engineer
Watershed Development and Soil Conservation
Jaisalmer
DIPRC/12378/26

सरकार
भारत
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
CMG, SDSC - SHAR SRIHARIKOTA - 524124

Brief E- TENDER NOTICE: CORRIGENDUM-I (SALE EXTENSION)
No: e-Tender Notice No.CMG/C/CON/268712(I) 268713(I) Dt: 15.07.2026

Refer to Tenders No 1. CMG/C/CON/268712 dated. 30.06.2026 Name of work: "Balance works for Package - D: Construction of LOSF storage bay for C32 main building, Chain link fencing, Deluge watershed, trenches, merlon stage pressurization room, Lpt for SLP Augmentation at SDSC SHAR" (Est. cost Rs. 167 Lakhs); and
2. Tender No CMG/C/CON/268713 dated 30.06.2026 Name of work: "Package D : Sub part : Construction of Effluent collection pit for LOFS SLP Augmentation at SDSC SHAR" (Est. cost Rs. 51 Lakhs); and
Sale period extended up to 27.07.2026

Interested tenderer may visit <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> or www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO for details.
Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/SDSC SHAR

TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED
Unit-1: Kagithapuram – 639 136. Karur Dist. Tamil Nadu
Unit-2: Mondipatti – 621306, Trichy District, Tamil Nadu

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS		
Tender No	Description	Due Date
262713 002395	Procurement of Sulphur Di-Oxide for Unit-I & II.	27.07.26
262713 002499	Procurement of Spares, Repairing works and Technical Supervisory Services for Overhauling of Centrifugal Compressor #4.	29.07.26
262713 002541	Bleached Softwood Kraft Pulp - (BSKP) FSC Mix for Unit-I.	29.07.26
262723 001580	Bleached Softwood Kraft Pulp (BSKP), Burst Index 6.0 for Unit-II.	03.08.26
262723 001581	Bleached Softwood Kraft Pulp (BSKP) for Unit-II.	05.08.26
262723 001582	BCTMP Softwood 70 - High Yield Pulp for Unit-II.	31.07.26
262723 001583	BCTMP Hardwood 70 - High Yield Pulp for Unit-II.	05.08.26
262723 001584	BCTMP Hardwood 80 - High Yield Pulp (Low Tensile) for Unit-II.	06.08.26
262723 001585	BCTMP Hardwood 80 - High Yield Pulp (Low Tensile) - FSC Mix for Unit-II.	04.08.26
262733 000152	Procurement of PP Bag for Power Bond Cement Packing (Size:29.3" X 20.5").	30.07.26
262723 001551	Procurement of Sodium Sulphate (In Jumbo Bags) for SRP of TNPL Unit-II.	30.07.26
262723 001589	Procurement of Double Sided Tape 50 MM (Repulable) - Length 50 Mtrs for TNPL Unit-II	29.07.26

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC Portal only. Detailed Terms & conditions are available in tender document at our websites: www.tnpl.com/ www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app
DIPR/2292/Tender/2026

Office of the Additional Chief Engineer (Project) PHED Ajmer
Qtr. No. II/2, PHED Colony, Vaishali Nagar, near RICO Watch Factory, Ph. No. 0145-2640265, email: acepajmer@gmail.com acepajmer@rajasthan.gov.in
S.No. F(AE/Proj/AJ/AR-JJM /2026-27/1962 Date: 09/07/2026

CORRIGENDUM NO. 7
(NIB Code:- PHE2526A6441 & UBN No. PHE2526WLOB13856)
In continuation to this office NIT No. 03/2025-26 issued vide letter no. 2436-2491 dated 11.02.2026. The following amendment are hereby notified:-

S. N.	Description	As per original NIT and Corrigendum 6	As per this corrigendum
1	Date & time for downloading of tender document	13.02.2026 at 10:00AM to 09.07.2026 up to 06:00PM	13.02.2026 at 10:00AM to 06.08.2026 up to 6:00PM
2	Date & time for online submission of tender	From 24.02.2026 at 10:00 AM to up to 09.07.2026 at 6:00 PM	Up to 06.08.2026 at 06:00PM
3	Date & time of physical submission of tender fee, RLS charges and EMD	10.07.2026 at 01:00 PM	Up to 07.08.2026 at 01:00 PM
4	Date & time of opening of technical bid	10.07.2026 at 03:00 PM	Up to 07.08.2026 at 03:00 PM

All other terms and conditions shall remain same as mentioned in tender document.
(K. K. Agarwal)
Additional Chief Engineer
(Project) PHED, Ajmer
DIPRC/12377/26

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियंता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, ग्रामीणवृत्त, जोधपुर
क्रमांक: 852 दिनांक: 09/07/2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या : 04 वर्ष 2026-27
NIB No. PWD2627A1577

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से सड़क निर्माण कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/अक एवं दूर संचार विभाग/रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के उपयुक्त श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समक्ष हों, से निविदाएं प्रेषित में & सड़क कार्य निम्न की लागत राशि रु. 556.50 लाख है के लिए ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

ऑनलाइन निविदा आवेदन कागजलॉड : 10 जुलाई 2026, 9:30 बजे से 29 जुलाई 2026, सायं एवं अपलोड करने की तारीख 03:00 बजे तक

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेब साइट <http://dipr.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। समुचित निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन सम्पादित की जायेगी। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाइट पर <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है। कार्यवार यू.सी.एन संख्या निम्नानुसार है।
1. PWD2627WSOB06728 2. PWD2627WSOB06729 (निरीत सूचना)
3. PWD2627WSOB06730 अधीक्षण अभियंता
सा.नि.वि. ग्रामीण वृत्त जोधपुर
DIPRC/12320/2026

DR. B.R. AMBEDKAR DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
9th Floor, Vishveshwaraiah Mini Tower, Dr. Ambedkar Veedhi, Bengaluru - 560 001. Ph: 080-22868870, 22867097, 22865192 Fax : 080-22860396, e-mail : mdadcl2011@gmail.com
No:ADCL/FOODCART/TENDER/2026-27 Date:14.07.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through KPP portal only)

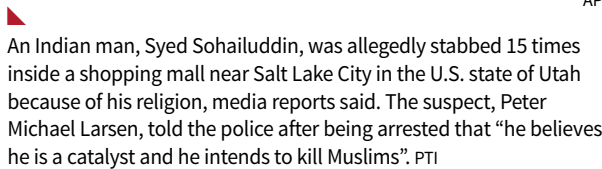
The Managing Director, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar Development Corporation Limited, Bengaluru invites tender for Supply of EV Food Carts (Electrical Fast Food Truck Trailers / Mobile Kitchen, Food Kiosk) for the Beneficiaries under Self-employment -Entrepreneurship Scheme for the year 2026-27 through e-procurement portal of Government of Karnataka (<https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>). Amount put to tender : Rs. 63.00 Crores and EMD Amount : Rs. 63.00 Lakhs.

Last date and time for submission of pre-bid queries: 27.07.2026 upto 17:00 Hrs. Pre Bid Meeting Date and Time: 28.07.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. Last date & Time for submission of Tender: 14.08.2026 at 17:30 Hrs. Date & Time of opening of Technical bid: 17.08.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. Demonstration of offered Vehicles by Bidders and evaluation by the Technical Committee: 24.08.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. Tentative Date & Time of opening of Commercial bid: 29.08.2026 at 11:30 Hrs. Venue of pre-bid meeting, opening of tenders & address for communication: Above Office Address.

Prospective bidders willing to participate in this tender can download the bid documents after visiting the website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/-
Managing Director
DIPRC/CP/A/1649/2026-27

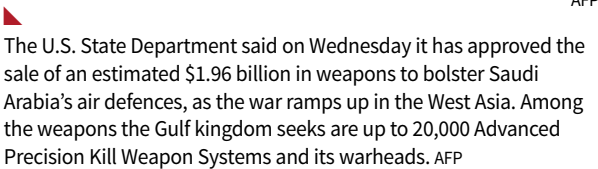
Indian national stabbed in the U.S. over his religion; suspect arrested



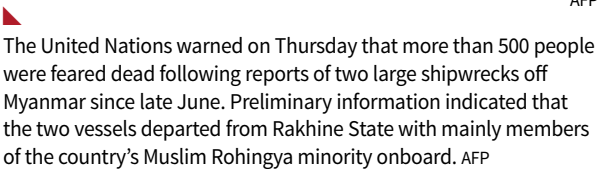
Zelenskyy's dismissal of Ukraine's Defence Minister sparks protests



U.S. approves nearly \$2 billion in weapons sales to Saudi Arabia



Over 500 feared dead in suspected shipwrecks off Myanmar, says UN



Israel 'will keep troops in Lebanon, Syria, and Gaza'

 $\Delta \text{CH-CH}_2$

We never stopped believing: Messi on the comeback in 'special fixture'



England manager Tuchel defends his tactics in agonising defeat



I dreamed of it, says Lautaro on his all-important match-winning goal



'Gutted' Kane admits England got it wrong after taking the lead



Argentina punches past a retreating England

Argentina coach Scaloni all praise for his troupe of great escape artists

Thin line between failure and folklore

Fowler, Kahn expect the final to be a tactical battle



forta-
t.

Junior success should fuel senior glory, says Karlsson

The Swedish paddler, a winner of five World Championships titles, feels his 'stubborn' trait has largely shaped a successful coaching career spanning nearly two decades; reckons UTT is doing a fantastic job in elevating the standard of the game

TABLE TENNIS

K. Keerthivasan
PANAJI

Sweden's Peter Karlsson admitted that he was "a bit stubborn" during his playing days, but only in the sense that he possessed an unshakeable belief in his own abilities. That unwavering self-confidence was one of the driving forces behind a glittering career in which he won five World Table Tennis Championships titles – four team (Dortmund 1989, Chiba 1991, Gothenburg

1993 and Kuala Lumpur 2000) and one men's doubles (in 1991 with Thomas von Scheele) – and climbed to a career-high world ranking of No. 5 in singles.

Same trait
The 57-year-old believes that the same trait has largely shaped his successful coaching career spanning nearly two decades. During an interaction with the media at a meet-and-greet event organised by UTT franchise HVR Kolkata Thunderblades, at the South Goa Table Tennis Council on Wednesday, Karlsson was categorical in

saying that Indian table tennis' next big leap would depend on how effectively the gap between outstanding junior success and sustained excellence at the senior level could be bridged.

Amazing results
"India is ranked 13th in the world in men's and 16th in women's. It has achieved amazing results. "Now, it starts to become really difficult to take the next step. And there, I think, what Ultimate Table Tennis is doing is fantastic," he said. At the same time, the legend, who has worked

with Sweden's leading players, including 2019 World Championships men's singles silver medalist Mattias Karlsson (formerly Mattias Falck), besides guiding the careers of Kristian Karlsson and Anton Kallberg, added: "It's going to be very interesting to see if India can transform good youth and junior players into good senior players. "Because on the youth side, India is doing extremely well. "If you see the results on the youth side and convert them into the senior side, India could be in the top five."



Karlsson.
INSTAGRAM/KARLSSONPETERIT

Abdusattorov ready to help Sindarov vs. Gukesh

CHESS

C. Shyam Sundar
CHENNAI

Nodirbek Abdusattorov has good memories of Chennai. He was at the forefront of Uzbekistan's spectacular run in the chess Olympiad in nearby Mamallapuram in 2022, with his defeat of D. Gukesh on the top board ensuring the gold for his team. Abdusattorov is back in the city for the Chennai Grand Masters tournament and is more than happy to return.



Abdusattorov. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The 21-year-old Uzbek, who is part of a group of rising stars from the Central Asian republic, said he was looking forward to the match against the World champion but wasn't focussing only on it. "This tournament is ve-

ry short. In some rounds, anything can happen, because it's a very young field," the former World Rapid champion said in an interaction. Abdusattorov has slipped under the radar in recent times with his compatriot Javokhir Sindarov stealing the spotlight with a triumph in last year's World Cup in Goa before dominating the field in the Candidates to set up a World championship match against Gukesh. He said he would help Sindarov in his preparation for the title clash. "I had joined his training camp for a week before the Can-

didates. For the upcoming World championship match, for sure, I will be part of his team. I will be training with him. From my perspective, he's my friend, he's close to me, and I will do my best to help him," Abdusattorov said. It is not common for chess players to have friendships, especially with rivals, but the young Uzbek superstars seem to be different. The Abdusattorov-Sindarov friendship could be crucial as Uzbekistan aims to win the gold in the Olympiad to be held back home in Samarkand.

AROUND THE CITY

Thirumurugan to meet Rohith for the honours

Thirumurugan of SRM College beat Rakshak Tharun of Loyola 6-2, 3-6, 6-3 in the men's singles semifinals of the RWD TNTA Tamil Nadu inter-collegiate tennis tournament at the DB Jain College courts on Thursday. Thirumurugan will meet Rohith Hari Balaji (Loyola) in the summit clash after the latter's opponent Allen Chris Joel (Kumaraguru Institutions) retired due to injury after the first game (1-0).

In the women's section, Sree Syleswari of SRM defeated her compatriot Joell Nichole in straight sets 7-5, 7-5, while in the other all-SRM semis, Lakshmi Prabha edged past B. Savitha 6-2, 6-3.

Abhishek's five-for headlines Heartfulness Intl. School NIOS-A's thumping victory
S. Abhishek's five for eight set up a 10-wicket win for

Heartfulness International School NIOS-A against Ramachandra Public School in the TNCA City Schools under-16 quarterfinal league match on Thursday. In another match, Rishab Mahlotra's unbeaten 98 powered PSBB Nungambakkam to a three-wicket win over Heartfulness International School NIOS-B. **The scores:** Don Bosco-B 112 in 41.5 overs (S. Sanjay 40, M.V. Gautam Garv 4/10, V. Abinav Santhosh 4/19) lost to Heartfulness Int. School CBSE, Kolapakkam 113/1 in 23.4 overs (M.V. Gautam Garv 4/9, B. Yashveer

49 n.o.). Ramachandras Public School 91 in 25.3 overs (V. Rithaash 32, M.P. Abhiman Sundar 4/31, S. Abhishek 5/8) lost to Heartfulness Int. School NIOS-A 95/0 in 14.2 overs (S. Ishan Praviit 40 n.o., Ruthvik Muralidharan 54 n.o.). St. Bede's-A 301/7 in 50 overs (J.A. Athier Sharafatheen 73, S. Abhishek Ram 49, S. Tanish 34, Royal Gangwani 60, S.C.P. Balasubramanian 3/32) bt St. Bede's-B 47 in 18.4 overs (Royal Gangwani 3/4, S. Pugazhendhi 3/16). Heartfulness Int. School NIOS-B 218 in 48.2 overs (R. Harshad 57, S. Sibeshraj 37, S.V. Rithik 3/35) lost to PSBB Nungambakkam 222/7 in 48.3 overs (Rishab Malhotra 98 n.o., Vansh Kumar Jain 34, R. Adhavan 3/35).

CONVERSION OF RELAY
BASED INTERLOCKING TO
ELECTRONIC INTERLOCKING

E-Tender Notice No. KIR-N-2026-K-17 Dated: 14-07-2026.

Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the president of India are invited for the works as detailed below:-

Name of work: Conversion of relay based interlocking to electronic interlocking at Siliguri Town station of Katihar Division (balance installations under priority category-3).

Tender Value: ₹3,91,57,374.59/- Earnest Money: ₹7,83,200/-

Date & time of closing of tender: At 15.00 hrs. & opening at 15.30 hrs. on 05-08-2026.

office. The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available upto 15.00 hrs. of 05-08-2026 in the website www.ireps.gov.in

DRM(S&T)/Katihar

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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

e-Tender Notice No. SER-OHE-KGP-TATA-2X25KV, dated 15.07.2026.

For and on behalf of President of India, Chief Electrical Engineer (Project), South Eastern Railway invites e-tender for the following work :

Name of work and its location : Design, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning for upgradation of Electric traction system from 1 x 25 KV to 2 x 25 KV traction system for Kharagpur - Tatanagar section of Kharagpur division of South Eastern Railway to meet 3000 MT loading target.

Approximate Cost of the work : ₹ 178,77,55,381.25.

Bid Security: ₹ 3,57,55,100/-

Cost of Tender Document: Nil.

Completion period of the work : 24 months.

Validity of Offer : 120 days from the date of opening of tender.

Last date of receiving queries : 11.08.2026 till 11.00 hrs.

Pre bid meeting : 11.08.2026 at 11.30 hrs.

Physical Submission of all documents: 02.09.2026.

Closing date of tender : 03.09.2026 (14:00 hrs. IST).

Website particulars where complete details of tender can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in (PR-485)

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ई-निविदा आमन्त्रण सूचना

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ई-निविदा सूचना सं०: 107 of 2026-27; कार्य का नाम व स्थान: Replacement of 0.61 mt. multiple span bridges (16 nos bridges) by RCC box bridge in KQW-SWF section in the Jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/Centra; अनुमानित लागत रुपये: 5,14,58,277.59; ब्याने की राशि रुपये: 10,29,200.00; निविदा सूचना संख्या 107of2026-27 निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की तिथि 03.08.2026 को 15:00 बजे तक है। वेबसाईट का विवरण जहाँ पर ई-निविदा देखी व सौरी जा सकती है www.ireps.gov.in

1018-AM/26

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NWRRailways

HPIDB HIMACHAL PRADESH INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT BOARD (Government of Himachal Pradesh)

Pre-Proposal Conference (Himachal Niketan)

The Government of Himachal Pradesh, through the Himachal Pradesh Infrastructure Development Board (HPIDB), proposes to appoint an Operator for the Operation, Maintenance and Management of the newly constructed Himachal Niketan at Dwarka, New Delhi under the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) mode. In this regard, the Government intends to hold a Pre-Proposal Conference with prospective bidders to obtain their feedback and suggestions prior to floating the tender/bid for the proposed project.

The Pre-Proposal Conference is scheduled to be held on 23.07.2026 (Thursday) at 11:30 A.M. at Himachal Niketan, Pocket-1, Opposite PNB Corporate Office, Sector-19, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075.

HPIDB looks forward to the active participation of all stakeholders in shaping a transparent, sustainable, and investor-friendly PPP framework for the project.

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION, PLEASE CONTACT:

Chief General Manager Himachal Pradesh Infrastructure Development Board New Himrus Building, Circular Road, Himland Shimla-171001, Himachal Pradesh, India Phone No.: +91 177-2626696, 2627312, 9805540343, 9816610205 Email: hpidb-hp@nic.in; website:https://hpiddb.hp.gov.in/

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION M.S. Building, Bangalore-560 001

E-No:ED/24/UTT/2026 Date: 16.07.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Selection of Vice-Chancellor of Tumkur University, Tumkur

1) The Government of Karnataka invites applications for the selection of Vice-Chancellor of Tumkur University, Tumkur as per section 14(2) of Karnataka State Universities Act, 2000 from eligible and distinguished Academicians/Professors with following credentials.

i) A person of the highest level of competence, integrity, morals and institutional commitment;

ii) A distinguished academician, with a minimum of ten years of experience as Professor in a University or ten years of experience in a reputed research and/or academic administrative organization with proof of having demonstrated academic leadership;

iii) As provided in the sec 14(5) and 14(6) of Karnataka State Universities Act, 2000, the Vice-Chancellor shall, subject to the pleasure of the Chancellor, hold the office for a maximum period of 04 years or until he attains the age of Sixty Seven years whichever is earlier. Consequently, a person to be appointed as Vice Chancellor shall have clear four years of tenure.

2) Persons interested in submitting their candidacy for the Vice-Chancellor of Tumkur University, Tumkur should make hard copies of the application in triplicate duly filled along with the academic, research credentials and administrative experience, achievements & other details in the proforma prescribed by the UGC within 30 days (including general holidays) from the date of publication of this advertisement, to:Secretary to Government, Higher Education Department, 6th Floor, Gate No:03, Room No. 601, (R & I Section), M.S.Building, Bangalore-560 001

3) Single soft copy of the application in PDF format should be sent to e-mail: tutsearchcommittee2026@gmail.com

4) In support of unblemished career and undoubted integrity, the applicant who is retired from service, should file a self attested certificate to the effect that no departmental/criminal enquiry is instituted/pending against him or no enquiry is culminated in penalties and he is neither having the tainted service history nor the appointment dispute. Whereas, in case of applicant in service, he should file a certificate of his employer in this regard. The concerned will be subjected to stringent action if certificates are found to be false.

5) The application proforma is available on the Government of Karnataka, Higher Education Department Website: https://hed.karnataka.gov.in and Tumkur University, Tumkur Website.

6) Incomplete applications, applications not made in prescribed proforma and applications received after the stipulated time limit will not be entertained. This office is not responsible for postal or other kinds of delays.

7) The candidature of those who indulge in undue influencing on the selection process through unethical means will stand cancelled.

Sd/- Secretary to Government, Higher Education Department

DIPR/CP/1673/NR/2026-27

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Will expansion lead to elevation?

With the 50-over format struggling for identity amid great response to the T20 version, there are question marks over whether the 14-team ODI World Cup will provide enough quality



GETTY IMAGES

R. Kaushik

It feels like it was only the other night that co-hosts Mexico and South Africa kicked off the 23rd edition of the FIFA World Cup, and here we are with only two of the gargantuan 104 matches left to play in the tournament.

One of them, the third-place playoff, is a match no team wants to feature in. It is not even a necessary evil, a consolation prize that offers scant to no consolation. Just days after suffering heartbreaking losses to Spain and Argentina respectively, expecting France and England to put on a show is asking for a little too much. But such are the demands on modern professional sport that the show must go on, no matter that the protagonists believe it is nothing if not a formality.

Contrary to the popular perception that accompanied the expansion of the World Cup to 48 teams for the first time in its long and storied history, this edition has been anything but lop-sided, predictable and unidimensional.

The success of Cape Verde, more than anyone else, is a massive shot in the arm for the sport's governing body, which had copped its fair share of criticism when it added 16 nations to the World Cup compared to the previous edition in what was seen largely as a self-appealing, populist move. Till date, Cape Verde remain the only team not to have lost to Spain in this edition, a result Lionel Messi-fuelled Argentina will seek to reprise in Sunday's final at the MetLife Stadium in New Jersey.

Such has been the overwhelming success of the tournament that FIFA boss Gianni Infantino has thrown up the realistic prospect of an even larger field at the next edition in four years' time. It will be jointly co-hosted by Spain, Portugal and Morocco with a game apiece in Argentina, Paraguay and Uruguay to commemorate the 100th anniversary of the tournament, first held in Uruguay in 1930.

Just a month prior to this public pondering, Infantino had joked that the only way Italy, the country of his birth and four-time champions, could qualify was if the field was expanded to 64 teams, "or maybe even 208". Obviously, that's not why Infantino's FIFA is mulling another expansion, though it isn't lost on anyone that the Italian national side has hit a terrible roadblock after failing to make it to the World Cup for a third edition on the trot.

Even as the 'Beautiful Game' is considering various possibilities, FIFA's cricketing counterpart, the International Cricket Council, announced an expanded field for the next 50-over World Cup, to be staged in 2027. At a time when the One-Day International version is battling for relevance and primacy, the constant change in formats is anything but ideal.

One would have thought the system in vogue for the last two editions – in



The ODI World Cup. GETTY IMAGES

England in 2019 and in India in 2023 where the 10 participating teams played each other once in a round-robin format with the top four making it to the semifinals – was fair and just because it pitted the strongest sides in the world against each other and offered insurance against a bad day in office or an unkind cut from the elements.

But apparently, those who are more invested in the sport and who are far more qualified to take such calls don't feel so, which is why the 2028 edition will be a 14-team affair, as the ICC had indicated more than five years ago.

Bilateral 50-over contests no longer hold the same interest, attention or standing as they once used to, when T20 cricket was not even in the realms of the imagination. Limited-overs cricket was driven globally entirely by the ODI iteration and series of five, six or even seven matches weren't uncommon. Now, even in the imminence of a World Cup, seldom do teams square off in a series of more than three games. It is perhaps in deference to a pronounced apathy from the fans to whom context has started to matter a lot more in the wake of the 20-over revolution that promises and delivers non-stop excitement, with the bonus of a decisive outcome guaranteed inside four hours (provided teams don't mess around with the overrate).

A thing of the past

Just the other day, Shubman Gill reflected nostalgically on the tri-series showdowns that once dominated the ODI ecosystem. Every summer in Australia, the host nation would lock horns with two other sides over an extended period culminating in a best-of-three finals.

It did sometimes appear too inflated and long drawn-out, but there was so much prestige attached to those trilateral contests. Victory in the finals was often considered next only to clinching the World Cup or the Champions Trophy (instituted in 1998 as the ICC KnockOut Trophy).

Indeed, who can forget the ecstasy in India when M.S. Dhoni's warriors swept the finals 2-0 in early 2008 in the immediacy of the Monkeygate scandal.



The T20 World Cup. GETTY IMAGES

The peerless Sachin Tendulkar was in the forefront of two amazing title clashes that justified Ricky Ponting's prediction that the scoreline in the finals would be 2-0 – except that his team was on the wrong side of the result.

The duels in Sharjah are memorable, not least the one in April 1998 when India sneaked into the final ahead of New Zealand on run rate after Tendulkar's magnificent Desert Storm that was more furious than even the sandstorm which first interrupted and then truncated the final league clash against Australia. And also when Tendulkar celebrated his 25th birthday in style with a second magnificent century in three nights to consign hitherto unbeaten Australia, the great Steve Waugh's Australia, to a crushing defeat.

Now, there are hardly any triangular competitions. Even several bilateral series are played in front of empty stands, and potentially the only occasion when more than two countries play in the same tournament is during the Asia Cup, which switches between 50- and 20-over versions depending on the format in which the next World Cup is to be played.

Rise of the shortest format

Given the packed calendars, the profusion of T20 leagues worldwide and a marked slant towards cramming as many 20-over games as possible into a tight timeframe, the 50-over game has almost been cannibalised, depending largely – if not only – on the flagship World Cup to keep its head just above the swirling water.

How will this 14-team World Cup play out next year? Only time will tell, though this isn't the first time the tournament will have this many teams. In any case, the 'actual' action will only begin from the second stage onwards, when 12 sides will be divided into two groups of six each.

The original plan, envisaged in June 2021, to have seven teams in each of the two pools, has been shelved. Rightly so, because of the fear of one-sided matches which will in turn impact both bums on the seats in South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia – the joint hosts – and a larger television audience that drives and decides the market value of broadcast

rights and sponsorship wars, among other things.

One set of pundits has argued that a World Cup, especially of the 50-over variety, must be a tight, compact competition involving only the cream so that the 'sanctity' of the event is maintained. They have dismissed Kenya's conquest of the West Indies in 1996 or Ireland's stunning defeat of England 15 years later as the occasional flash in the pan that does not justify the diluting of the field. They argue that as it is, the ICC ODI team rankings encompass only 20 teams, and to have 14 of them playing in a World Cup is a little much, even if only 12 will eventually be in the running for top honours with two teams being eliminated in the first triangular round.

They contend that if there is a perceived need, or even a case, to have more teams in a World Cup, it should be accommodated in the 20-over kind where 93 teams enjoy ICC rankings, from recently crowned No. 1s England to Costa Rica, who currently bring up the foot of the table.

While they might not be thrilled at the 50-over showpiece entity becoming numerically larger, they may be fine with 20 teams competing in the T20 World Cup for the third successive time.

The vehicle to popularity

In its bid to globalise the sport and spread its tentacles to hitherto untouched territories, the ICC chose to use T20s as the vehicle to catch the eye of those in, say, Japan and Italy, in Fiji and Brazil. That it has succeeded to a large extent in its stated desire to attract new nations to its fold is beyond question – at its Annual Conference in Edinburgh on Wednesday, the ICC officially inducted Mauritius as its 111th member nation.

The growing pull of the dramatic 20-over variant has resulted in the return of cricket to the Olympic fold at the 2028 summer Games in Los Angeles, a shot in the arm for a discipline that has been out of the quadrennial extravaganza since its only appearance at the Paris Games in 1900 when only two contestants, Great Britain and the hosts, battled for the gold medal.

While the 20-over game, with its unquestioned charm and magnetic tug, will lure many other countries to the ICC fold, it is hard to see its longer white-ball counterpart taking deep root in too many nations that are not already playing the sport. Against this backdrop, the debate on whether the 50-over World Cup should continue to mushroom numerically will rage on.

There is no right answer, of course. Cricket is on course-correction mode, seeking to erase its 'elitist' reputation. But when only 12 countries play the longest, most traditional format (Tests) and only eight more are part of the ODI ecosystem, it finds itself in the middle of a grim battle somewhat lightened by the tremendous response to the slam-bang 20-over module.

THE GIST

▼

Bilateral ODI contests no longer hold the same interest, attention or standing as they once used to. There are hardly any triangular competitions

▼

One set of pundits has argued that a World Cup, especially of the 50-over variety, must be a tight, compact competition

▼

The growing pull of the dramatic 20-over variant has resulted in the return of cricket to the Olympic fold

HEALTH

Beyond weight loss: how GLP-1s can affect your skin, hair and nails

The skin, hair and nails are highly responsive to changes in weight, nutrition, hormones, inflammation and physiological stress; patients taking GLP-1 drugs must plan ahead and ensure they are used carefully, with coordination between the prescribing physician and a dermatologist

Monisha Madhumita

GLP-1 (Glucagon-Like Peptide-1) based medicines have changed the management of obesity, type 2 diabetes and metabolic health across the world. Drugs such as and tirzepatide are prescription medicines, however, not cosmetic treatments. Their primary role is medical: improving weight-related health, blood sugar control and cardiometabolic risk. However, their effects are often visible externally. For this reason, dermatology is becoming an important part of the GLP-1 conversation.

Weight-skin connection

The skin, hair and nails are highly responsive to changes in weight, nutrition, hormones, inflammation and physiological stress. When a person loses weight rapidly on GLP-1 treatment, changes may be seen in the face, body, scalp and nails. These changes are not usually dangerous, but they can affect comfort, appearance, confidence and quality of life. In some patients, they may also signal nutritional deficiency, worsening of an underlying condition, or the need for medical intervention.

The most widely discussed change is facial volume loss. As body weight reduces, facial fat may reduce as well. Some people notice hollowing of the cheeks or temples, deeper folds, looser skin around the jawline, or a more tired appearance.

The phrase ‘Ozempic face’ is commonly used, but it is not medically precise. These changes can occur after any significant or rapid weight loss, whether or not medication is involved. What is new now, is the number of patients now experiencing medically assisted weight loss and seeking advice about the aesthetic consequences.

The skin on the body may also change. After substantial weight reduction, loose skin can appear over the abdomen, arms, thighs, breasts or under the chin. In humid climates, these folds can become sites of sweating, friction, itching, pigmentation, intertrigo, fungal infections or bacterial irritation. In skin of colour, post-inflammatory pigmentation in these areas can be persistent and distressing. For some patients, what begins as loose skin may become a recurring medical problem involving itching, odour, rash or infection.

Effects on hair

Hair shedding is another common concern. Many patients report increased hair fall a few months after starting treatment. This often resembles telogen effluvium, a temporary shedding pattern that can follow rapid weight loss, illness, surgery, childbirth, crash dieting or nutritional stress. The medication may not be the only reason. Reduced intake of protein, iron, vitamin D, vitamin B12, zinc or overall calories may contribute. Some



Addressing concerns: When a person loses weight rapidly on GLP-1 treatment, changes may be seen in the face, body, scalp and nails. For this reason, dermatology is becoming an important part of the GLP-1 conversation. GETTY IMAGES

patients may also have underlying female pattern hair loss, PMOS, thyroid disease, low ferritin or autoimmune hair loss that becomes more apparent during weight loss. Hair fall during GLP-1 treatment should therefore be assessed properly rather than dismissed. After thorough examination, depending on the diagnosis, treatment may include topical minoxidil, low-dose oral minoxidil, correction of nutritional deficiencies, anti-androgen therapy in some women, platelet-rich plasma, treatment of dandruff or scalp inflammation, or clinical monitoring when the pattern is self-limiting.

Nail changes receive less attention but remain relevant. Patients may notice brittle nails, peeling, ridging, slower growth or easy breakage. These changes may reflect reduced nutrition, frequent wet work, thyroid disease, eczema, psoriasis, fungal infection or anaemia. Treatment should be directed at the cause: moisturising the nail folds, avoiding repeated trauma from harsh manicures, checking for fungal infections when indicated, and correcting deficiencies when present.

GLP-1s to treat skin diseases

There is now a growing interest in the role of GLP-1s in inflammatory skin disease. These medicines may have anti-inflammatory effects beyond weight loss and blood sugar control. Early reports suggest possible benefits in conditions such as psoriasis and hidradenitis suppurativa, especially in patients who also have obesity, insulin resistance or type 2 diabetes.

This is clinically plausible. Psoriasis and hidradenitis suppurativa are not

GLP-1s are not beauty drugs. They are powerful metabolic medicines with visible dermatological consequences and early anti-inflammatory promise

simply local skin problems. They are chronic inflammatory diseases that often overlap with metabolic dysfunction. Weight loss, improved insulin sensitivity and reduced systemic inflammation may improve disease severity in some patients. Early studies and case reports suggest that GLP-1 therapy may reduce flares, pain, scaling, drainage or itching in selected individuals.

However, the evidence is still developing. GLP-1s should not yet be presented as standard dermatology treatments for psoriasis or hidradenitis suppurativa. Their role may be most relevant when inflammatory skin disease and metabolic disease coexist, but larger controlled studies are needed.

Planning ahead

From an aesthetic perspective, the priority should be to plan rather than panic. Patients who already have hair loss, acne, pigmentation, psoriasis, eczema, hidradenitis suppurativa, loose skin concerns or nutritional deficiencies may benefit from a baseline dermatology review before, or early during treatment. This is especially important for women, vegetarians, people with PMOS, post-partum patients, those with heavy menstrual bleeding, and patients with a history of bariatric surgery or low iron stores.

Skincare during GLP-1 treatment should be simple, consistent and barrier-supportive: a gentle cleanser, regular moisturiser, sunscreen, and treatment of specific concerns as they arise. Retinoids, peels, lasers, radiofrequency, ultrasound tightening, fillers, biostimulators, platelet-rich plasma or surgery may all have a role in selected patients. However, timing matters. Major aesthetic procedures are often better planned once weight has stabilised, because ongoing weight loss can alter facial volume, skin laxity and procedural outcomes.

Multi-pronged approach

The central message is coordination of care. The endocrinologist or prescribing physician manages the indication for treatment, dose escalation, metabolic response, systemic side effects and long-term safety. The dermatologist manages the visible and inflammatory consequences: hair shedding, skin laxity, pigmentation, acne, intertrigo, psoriasis, hidradenitis suppurativa, nail changes and procedural planning.

GLP-1s are not beauty drugs. They are powerful metabolic medicines with visible dermatological consequences and early anti-inflammatory promise. Used carefully, and with close collaboration between the dermatologist and endocrinologist, they can support metabolic health while helping patients manage changes in their skin, hair, nails and aesthetic confidence in a safe and informed way.

(Dr. Monisha Madhumita is a consultant dermatologist at Saveetha Medical College, Chennai. mail.monisha.m@gmail.com)

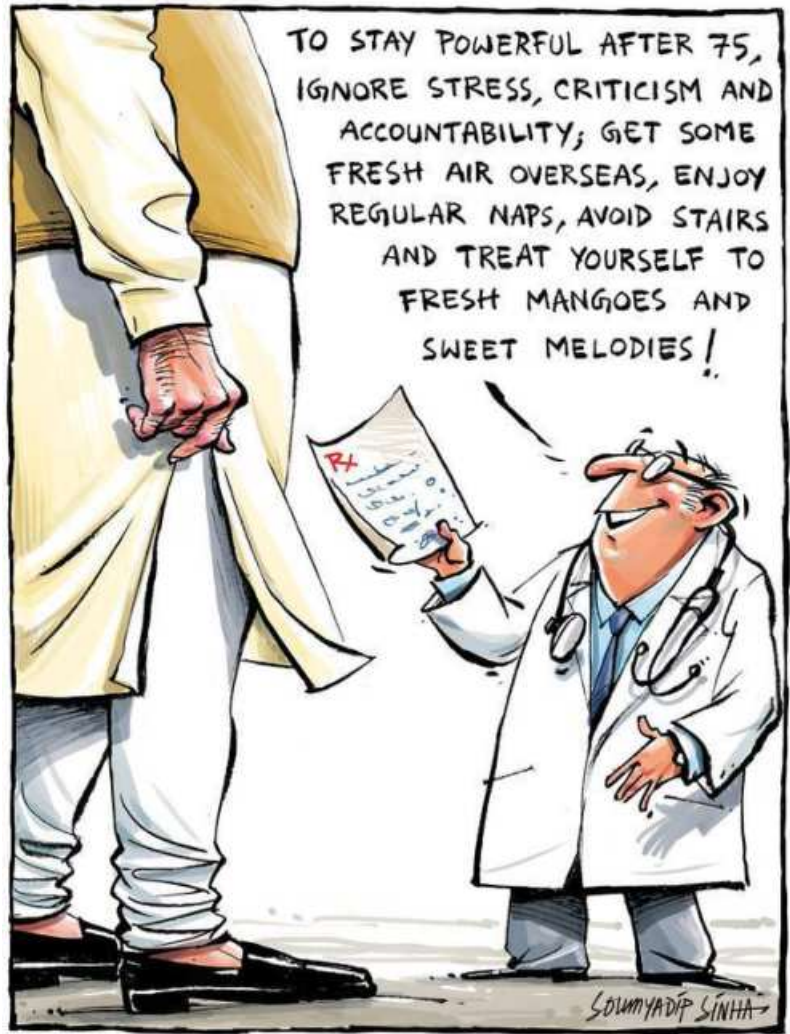
THE GIST

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HUMERUS



Cyclosporiasis outbreak: what is gastrointestinal illness that has affected over 1,500 in the U.S.

Zubeda Hamid

A widespread outbreak of a gastrointestinal illness has been reported in the United States. The infection, cyclosporiasis, caused by the cyclospora parasite, occurs when people consume food or water that contains the parasite.

According to the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, in a health advisory issued on July 14, it has received reports of 1,645 confirmed domestic cases of cyclosporiasis since May 1 and is aware of 5,100 cases that require further analysis to confirm the illness, from 34 States, substantially higher than the 249 cases reported in the country by this same time last year. Because cyclosporiasis is often underdiagnosed and underreported, the true number of illnesses is likely higher than what has been reported, it noted. At present, a specific food item has not yet been confirmed as the source.

Cyclosporiasis is a type of food poisoning, caused by the microscopic parasite, *Cyclospora cayetanensis*. It spreads through the faeco-oral route, which means that



Cyclosporiasis is a type of food poisoning, caused by the microscopic parasite, *Cyclospora cayetanensis*. GETTY IMAGES

food or water contaminated by faeces containing the parasite, cause the illness. It does not spread from person to person. While it is usually not life-threatening, symptoms can range from mild to severe and may last from anywhere between a few days to over a month. Symptoms usually begin about a week after exposure. The main symptom is frequent, explosive, watery diarrhoea. Other symptoms include bloating, loss of appetite, stomach

cramps, fatigue and even weight loss. Sometimes vomiting and low-grade fever may be experienced.

Anyone can contract the infection. In children, the elderly and those with weak immune symptoms, the infection may be severe. Untreated, the symptoms can last for a long time and patients can relapse as well. Complications can include severe dehydration, malabsorption (a digestive disorder where your intestine is unable to absorb nutrients), cholecystitis (inflammation of the gall bladder), and reactive arthritis (joint inflammation).

Testing and treatment

Testing for cyclosporiasis is challenging, because the parasite might not shed enough to be detected in one stool sample, and it is not part of routine stool testing. This means that patients may have to more than one sample over several days for an accurate diagnosis. Stool PCR tests to identify the parasite's DNA and stool microscopy that identifies the parasite's eggs can diagnose the condition.

As far as treatment goes, the CDC

recommends treating confirmed cases of cyclosporiasis with 7-10 days of trimethoprim-sulfamethoxazole (TMP-SMX) for adults and children aged over two months. Longer courses may be considered for patients with immunocompromising conditions. Hydration is also recommended.

While the infection may go away on its own without treatment, it can put patients at risk of complications and the CDC recommends visiting a clinician if you have prolonged or watery diarrhoea, especially if it lasts more than a few days.

This is not the first cyclosporiasis outbreak in the U.S. Previous outbreaks have been linked to consuming contaminated fresh produce. Fruits and vegetables tied to cyclosporiasis outbreaks include: leafy greens, lettuce, spinach, basil, cilantro and parsley as well as other produce such as raspberries and snow peas.

The CDC recommends reducing risk by thoroughly washing fresh produce under clean running water before eating and by following safe food handling practices. (zubeda.h@thehindu.co.in)

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Value of critical imports identified for manufacturing push

51 \$ in billion. India is seeking to push domestic manufacturing across a pool of items currently worth \$51 billion in imports, as the Prime Minister Narendra Modi seeks to reduce the country's reliance on overseas suppliers. The nation imported \$775 billion worth of goods in the 12 months ended March 2026, a government source said. REUTERS

Indian seafarers stranded on the west of Hormuz

15,000 India has advised ship managers and owners against deploying Indian seafarers on vessels passing through the Strait of Hormuz amid rising security risks. Over 15,000 Indians remain stranded west of Hormuz, according to the Forward Seamen's Union of India. REUTERS

Minimum wage raise in Vietnam planned for next year

7.8 in per cent. Vietnam's National Wage Council will submit a plan to raise the minimum wage by an average of 7.8% across the country's four regions in 2027. If approved, the new minimum wage would range from 4.04 million dong to 5.70 million dong (\$153.86-\$217.08) per month, the government said in a statement. REUTERS

Premium Lilium bulbs planted over past 3 days in Choglamsar

50,000 More than 50,000 premium Lilium bulbs have been planted at Choglamsar Flower Field in Ladakh, with the first bloom expected in the first week of September, the officials said. It is set to become India's largest organised high-altitude floriculture park. PTI

Land approved for Phase-II acquisition for three ports in A.P.

6248 The Andhra Pradesh government on Thursday approved the Phase-II land acquisition of 6,248 acres at a cost of ₹1,638 crore for the development of three ports — Mulapeta, Machilipatnam and Ramayapatnam. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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How serious is Kudankulam data leak?

What exactly was leaked in the data breach? How did it occur? Did the breach affect any nuclear or reactor-related systems? Who was responsible for protecting the data? Why is the leak significant?

EXPLAINER

Aroon Deep

The story so far:

In Wednesday, reports broke out that multiple gigabytes of data pertaining to operations at the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant in Tirunelveli district of Tamil Nadu had been copied and subsequently leaked as part of a ransomware attack. *Reuters* reported that the breach was part of an infiltration into Reliance Anil Dhirubhai Ambani Group's Reliance Infrastructure Ltd, and contained 14.3 GB of data on the power plant's operations. The data has been hosted on World Leaks, which is a Dark Web site hosted by cybercriminals who infect vulnerable firms with ransomware, threatening to leak the data if the ransom is not paid. The site claimed that the ransom was indeed not paid, and so it leaked the data. *The Hindu* opened the site and reviewed the index of files, which amount overall to 1.2TB, a slice of which pertained to the Kudankulam plant.

Was the reactor affected by the data leak?

"The files do not pertain to the core reactor's operations, which are the most sensitive in a nuclear setup," Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL) said in a statement. "NPCIL reiterates that the information claimed to be available in the public domain pertains only to conventional Balance of Plant (BOP) common service facilities and does not relate to any nuclear safety, or nuclear security-related systems or information," it said in a statement.

A spokesperson for the Reliance Group told *The Hindu* that it "was informed by Yotta Data Services Private Limited (Yotta), its third-party data centre service



A view of the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant in Tirunelveli district of Tamil Nadu. N. RAJESH

provider, of a cybersecurity incident involving an attempted ransomware attack that resulted in a partial breach of data hosted on one of Yotta's servers," and that "Yotta has confirmed that enhanced security monitoring and preventive controls are now in place. The Company has directed Yotta to conduct a detailed investigation and submit a report."

"No ransomware execution, data loss or lateral movement occurred," Reliance said in a stock exchange filing. The files reportedly include multiple drawings of "blueprints and supplier details, meeting and inspection records, equipment reviews," and a \$112 million insurance policy against terrorist attacks, though it is unclear what the premium amount for this insured sum is.

What did Yotta say about the cyber incident?

Yotta, which runs data centres across the country, characterised Reliance as its "customer's private cloud environment," but said it took steps to address the infiltration as it was detected on May 29.

"Yotta's managed endpoint security controls detected suspicious activity on a file server of our customer, Reliance Infrastructure," the company told *The Hindu*. "We acted immediately: the suspicious process was terminated, and the affected server was isolated, preventing the suspected ransomware from executing. Our technical assessment confirmed no evidence of ransomware encryption and no lateral movement to any other server or system within the customer's private cloud environment."

The incident was limited to this single customer-managed server, with no impact on any other Yotta customer or on Yotta's shared cloud platforms, AI cloud infrastructure, datacentre infrastructure or other services."

Why does the data leak matter?

The revelations have sparked "absolute commotion" among top officials at the power plant, even as they downplay the impact of the findings.

The plant has commissioned two 1,000 Mwe VVER reactors, allowing for a power supply of up to two gigawatts. The reactors are built in partnership with the Russian firm Rosatom, and the government is planning four more such units, which would triple the installed power production capacity at the facility.

THE GIST

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Why is Maharashtra's Ladki Bahin scheme under scrutiny?

What do beneficiary cuts and CAG findings reveal about its implementation?

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit

The story so far:

Ahead of the 2024 Assembly elections, the Maharashtra government launched the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana. Under this scheme, eligible women in the State receive ₹1,500 every month through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT). At its peak, the scheme covered 2.43 crore beneficiaries. However, successive rounds of verification over the past two years have led to the removal of lakhs of beneficiaries, bringing the total down to about 1.66 crore women.

The recent information about the removal of lakhs of women from the beneficiaries' list has sparked criticism, and the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) has raised concerns about the scheme.

Who is eligible to receive funds under the scheme?

Women who are residents of Maharashtra, aged between 21 and 65 years, with an Aadhaar-linked bank

account, and belonging to a family with an annual income of less than ₹2.5 lakh are eligible to receive benefits under the scheme. Women of any marital status are eligible. However, only one woman per family can avail of the benefit.

The State government has said the scheme is aimed at promoting the economic independence of women. It also seeks to improve their health and nutritional status, and strengthen their role in family decision-making, according to the government. The scheme is implemented by the State's Women and Child Development Department.

What are the red flags raised by the CAG in the latest report?

The CAG said the implementation of the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana during 2024-25 was marked by "significant deficiencies in Budget estimation, expenditure control, and financial management." While the scheme was allocated ₹29,693.09 crore for the fiscal year, the government incurred an expenditure of ₹33,237.24 crore, resulting in an excess expenditure of ₹3,541.16

crore. The CAG described the excess expenditure as "unjustified" and said the Women and Child Development Department failed to provide any specific justification for the overspending. It also observed that funds for the scheme were mobilised by reappropriating allocations from other schemes. For instance, ₹3,490.75 crore was reappropriated from the Lek Ladki Yojana. The State's supplementary Budget also allocated ₹26,200 crore for the scheme.

The CAG said that the scheme undermined the principles of budgetary discipline, financial propriety and legislative control over public finances. It said that "significant excess expenditure remained unexplained" and that large sums were drawn and parked in the Disbursing Officer's Virtual Personal Deposit Account (VPDA). "This indicates that the funds were not required for immediate utilisation and were drawn without actual expenditure needs, contrary to the principles of budgetary discipline and financial propriety," the CAG observed.

"A test check of vouchers exceeding

₹1,000 crore relating to the scheme, aggregating ₹29,732.01 crore, showed that ₹15,586 crore drawn between January and March 2025 was transferred to the Drawing and Disbursing Officer's VPDA," the report said.

Why have so many names been removed from the beneficiaries' list?

At its peak, the scheme had 2.43 crore beneficiaries. According to the Maharashtra government, the number of beneficiaries has fallen from 2.43 crore to 1.66 crore. The government said the names were removed after multiple rounds of verification found that some beneficiaries were no longer eligible. It maintained that there has been no change in the eligibility norms and attributed the reduction to the verification process.

The government also cited that the mandatory e-KYC requirement as a key reason for the drop in the number of beneficiaries, saying many women failed to complete the process. A Shiv Sena leader has now urged the State to extend the deadline for completing the e-KYC process. Meanwhile, the Opposition has accused the government of using the scheme to secure electoral gains. The Congress has demanded the immediate restoration of benefits for lakhs of women who were excluded over e-KYC-related issues, and called for an inquiry into the implementation of the scheme.

The Opposition has also criticised the government for failing to fulfil its promise of increasing the monthly assistance from ₹1,500 to ₹2,100 ahead of the State Assembly elections.

THE GIST

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FIFA World Cup: a quiz on FIFA controversies over the years

Know your English

Word of the day

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